

Complete Speaking Test

part 1

1. How did your parents chose your name?

“What’s in a name?”—a lot, if you ask my mother. She chose mine with great care because she felt it carried strength, dignity, and character—qualities she hoped I’d grow into. It holds deep personal meaning for her, and she picked it with immense pride and love.

2. Does your name have any special meaning?

Yes, it does. My name reflects strength and dignity. It symbolizes good character and is often associated with leadership and respect in our culture. So, it’s not just a name—it carries meaning that inspires me to live up to it.

3. Is your name is common or unusual in your country?

It’s actually quite common in my country. You’ll find many people with the same name, especially because it’s culturally and religiously significant. But even though it’s popular, I believe everyone gives their name a unique identity through their actions and personality.

4. If you could change the name, would you? why or why not?

I’m a bit surprised by this question because I’ve never really thought about changing my name. I feel quite connected to it—it holds sentimental value and reflects my family’s love and hopes for me. Honestly, even if given the chance, I wouldn’t trade it for anything. It feels like a part of who I am.

Part 2. Cue Card

PART 2

Describe a TV documentary you watched that was particularly interesting.

You should say:

**what the documentary was about
why you decided to watch it
what you learnt during the documentary
and explain why the TV documentary was particularly interesting.**

To say it opened my eyes would be an understatement. A TV documentary that really left a lasting impression on me was *"The Social Dilemma"* on Netflix. It dives deep into how social media platforms use data and algorithms to manipulate human behavior — all to keep us glued to our screens and make money off our attention.

I ended up watching it after a friend told me, *"If you think you're in control of your social media habits, think again."* That line piqued my curiosity. Also, I'd noticed how I was spending hours scrolling through Instagram without even realizing it — like I was on autopilot — so I thought it might be worth digging into the science behind that.

What I learned during the documentary honestly gave me chills. Former tech insiders from major companies like Facebook and Google explained how these platforms track every click, every pause, and even our emotions — just to serve us content that keeps us engaged. One expert said, *"If you're not paying for the product, you are the product,"* and that line stuck with me. The documentary also dramatized the story of a teenager who gradually becomes addicted to social media, which made the message hit even harder.

What made it particularly interesting was how it balanced cold, hard facts with real-life storytelling. It didn't feel like a boring lecture — it felt like someone was pulling back the curtain on something we see every day but don't fully understand.

All in all, *The Social Dilemma* really changed the way I use technology. I turned off a lot of notifications after that, and now I try to stay more mindful. Honestly, it was a real wake-up call.

Part 3

1. What are the most popular kind of TV programs in your country?

Statement: In my country, drama serials and reality shows are definitely the most popular types of TV programmes.

Explanation: People enjoy watching content that reflects real emotions or everyday issues, and dramas often explore family, love, and social problems, which really resonate with the audience. Reality shows, on the other hand, are engaging because they bring a sense of competition, suspense, and entertainment.

Example: For instance, shows like *Mere Paas Tum Ho* or *Pakistan Idol* gained huge popularity because they kept people emotionally invested and offered something fresh each episode.

2. **Do you think there are too many game shows on TV nowadays? Why?**

Statement: Yes, I do believe there are too many game shows on TV nowadays.

Explanation: TV channels often prioritize entertainment over quality content because they want to attract high ratings and advertising revenue. Game shows are easy to produce and attract large audiences, so they're a safe bet for broadcasters.

Example: For example, shows like *Jeeto Pakistan* are on almost every day during Ramadan and special occasions — they're fun, but sometimes it feels repetitive and lacks meaningful content.

3. **Do you think TV is the main way for people to get the news in your country? What other ways are there?**

Statement: These days, TV is still one of the main sources, but it's no longer the only or most trusted one.

Explanation: Many people, especially the younger generation, prefer to get their news online through social media or news websites because it's faster and more convenient.

Example: For instance, during major events like elections or floods, people may watch TV for full coverage, but they often check Twitter or YouTube first for real-time updates and opinions.

4. What types of products are advertised most often on TV?

Statement: In my country, products related to food, beauty, and mobile networks are advertised the most.

Explanation: These industries have a wide customer base and face tough competition, so they heavily invest in TV ads to stay in the public eye.

Example: You'll often see ads for cooking oils, fairness creams, and telecom bundles like *Jazz* or *Zong* between popular drama serials or sports events.

5. Do you think that people pay attention to adverts on TV? Why do you think that is?

Statement: Honestly, most people don't pay much attention to TV ads unless they're really catchy or informative.

Explanation: Because of how frequent and repetitive ads have become, viewers often switch channels or use ad breaks to do something else. Only creative or emotionally appealing ads tend to grab attention.

Example: A great example is the *Surf Excel* "Daag achay hotay hain" campaign — people remember it because it had a powerful message and smart storytelling.

6. How important are regulations on TV advertising?

Statement: I believe regulations are extremely important when it comes to TV advertising.

Explanation: Without proper rules, companies might use false claims or target vulnerable audiences like children, which can be harmful. Regulations ensure honesty and protect public interest.

Example: For example, in some countries, sugary drinks or junk food ads are banned during children's TV hours — this kind of rule helps promote healthy habits in young viewers.

Test 2

14. Describe a skill that you can teach other people

What is it
When you learned it
How can you teach others
How do you feel about this skill

Well, teaching is something that doesn't just require knowledge — it demands patience, clarity, and a heart that genuinely wants to help others grow. The skill I'd love to teach others is advanced machine learning. It might sound like a tough nut to crack, but once the concepts click, it's incredibly powerful and even fun.

I learned this skill during my university days, and over time, I polished it through hands-on projects and endless late-night problem-solving. What sets me apart as a teacher is that I don't just teach from slides — I explain things in a way that sticks. I believe in the idiom, "Don't just give them fish, teach them how to fish." I focus on building intuition first and then gradually take students into the deeper waters of algorithms and models.

My juniors and even some of my classmates often come to me when they're stuck — not because I know everything, but because I can explain things in plain English without sounding like a textbook. I use real-life analogies, break down problems step by step, and always keep the learning environment light and friendly. As they say, "You catch more flies with honey than with vinegar."

Moreover, I always encourage questions and make sure everyone feels heard. I've even applied to teach at a university because I believe it's high time to give back. After all, "knowledge is power, but sharing knowledge is superpower." Teaching makes me feel alive — like I'm shaping someone's future, one concept at a time.

Part 3

1. Should teachers be funny when they teach?

Without a doubt, using humor in teaching can be a game changer. A touch of laughter can break the ice, lighten the mood, and make the learning environment more welcoming. When students feel relaxed, they're more likely to open up, ask questions, and engage with the lesson — after all, *"a merry heart makes light work."*

However, there's a fine line to walk. Teachers should know when to bring humor into the room and when to be serious. If overdone, it can lead to a loss of discipline and focus. As the saying goes, *"Too much sugar spoils the tea."* So, a balanced approach is key.

Example: I remember a math teacher from school who always used jokes related to formulas or funny real-life examples. It made even the most complex topics easier to grasp — and enjoyable too!

2. What qualities should teachers have?

Teaching isn't just a profession; it's a calling. The most vital quality a teacher must have is **excellent communication skills**. If a teacher cannot explain a complex concept in a simple way, the whole point of teaching is lost.

Secondly, a teacher should be a **keen observer**. Every student learns differently — some are quick as lightning, others take their time. Good teachers can sense when a student is struggling and adapt their style accordingly. *"Reading between the lines"* is a crucial skill here.

Finally, **patience is the name of the game**. Sometimes, explaining something ten times still won't be enough — but a great teacher doesn't give up.

3. Which do you think are more important, practical skills or academic skills?

Example: I once had to explain recursion to one of my juniors. It took several attempts and different examples, but I stayed patient and tried new approaches until he finally got it. That moment of clarity in his eyes was priceless.

Both practical and academic skills go hand in hand, like two sides of the same coin. But the importance depends largely on the field and the individual's goals.

Academic skills provide a strong theoretical foundation, which is essential for fields like law, medicine, and research. On the other hand, **practical skills** are the bread and butter of industries like tech, arts, trades, and business.

“At the end of the day,” what matters is the ability to apply what you know in the real world. Book knowledge without practical application is like having a car with no fuel.

Example: A software developer who knows the theory but has never written a line of code will struggle. But someone who has practiced coding hands-on will solve real-world problems more effectively.

4. Which age group is the best at learning new things?

Honestly, I believe *“learning has no expiry date.”* While younger minds might pick up things faster due to better memory and flexibility, adults bring life experience, discipline, and a sense of purpose to the table.

We’ve seen people in their 60s or even 70s learning new languages, picking up coding, or pursuing higher education. The key lies in curiosity and willingness — not age.

Example: My uncle learned graphic design at 50 and now works as a freelancer. His story proves that *“where there’s a will, there’s a way.”*

Task 04:

2. Describe a famous person you would like to meet

You should say:

- Who he/she is
- How you knew him/her
- How/where you would like to meet him/her
- And explain why you would like to meet him/ her

One famous person I would absolutely love to meet is **Diljit Dosanjh**.

He’s not just the most popular Punjabi singer, but also a well-known Bollywood actor who has made a name for himself both in India and abroad.

I’ve known about him since I was a child — I basically **grew up with his songs playing in the background**. I still remember doing a dance performance to one of

his hit songs at my school's annual function. His music brings back a flood of memories, and it's been the **soundtrack to many joyful moments** in my life.

What I admire the most is **his rags-to-riches story**. He started out as a small-town singer and climbed his way up to become an international icon — proof that **hard work really does pay off**. He didn't get success overnight; he had to **go the extra mile** to be where he is today.

Recently, he went on a world tour, and I was lucky enough to catch one of his concerts in Dubai. I even managed to buy a **fan pit ticket**, so I was just a few feet away from him. Seeing him perform live, that too from so close, honestly **felt like a dream come true**.

The crowd, the energy, the vibe — it was all just **out of this world**. It's a memory that's **etched in my heart forever**.

He's also the first Punjabi singer to perform at **Coachella**, one of the biggest music festivals in the world. That moment really gave me goosebumps and made me even prouder to be one of his fans. It was like watching someone from your hometown **take on the world stage**.

I really look up to him, not just because he's famous, but because he's shown that you can **stay true to who you are** and still make it big. He's not only made a name for himself, but he's also **put Punjabi music on the global map**, which is no small feat.

Meeting him would honestly be one of the **highlights of my life**.

Part 3:

1. What are the advantage and disadvantage of being a famous child?

One major advantage of being a famous child is that they receive a lot of attention, love, and opportunities from a very young age. For example, they might get to act in TV commercials, travel the world, or meet famous people. This can give them a strong start in life and open doors that others might never even imagine.

However, there's a flip side to it. Such children often **miss out on a normal childhood**. Instead of playing in the park or going to birthday parties, they may be attending rehearsals, events, or press interviews. The constant spotlight can put them under pressure, and they may also **struggle with anxiety or burnout** at an

early age. For instance, we've seen many child celebrities who faced mental health issues as they grew older because of the stress they experienced early in life.

2. **What can today's children do to become famous?**

In today's digital age, there are more opportunities than ever before for kids to become famous. They can use platforms like **YouTube, TikTok, or Instagram** to showcase their talents. If a child is good at something like dancing, painting, singing, or even comedy, they can share videos online and possibly go viral.

For example, there was a young girl who became globally famous just by posting videos of her cooking skills with her mom. She ended up getting invited to cooking shows and even signed brand deals. However, it's important to note that not every child wants or needs to be famous — and not all viral fame is positive. Parents must guide their children so they pursue fame **for the right reasons**, and not just for attention.

3. **What can children do with their fame?**

Children can use their fame in many positive ways. They can **inspire their peers**, raise awareness about important issues, or contribute to charities. For instance, some young celebrities have used their platforms to support environmental causes or campaign against bullying. These efforts not only make a difference in the world but also help the child grow into a responsible adult.

However, fame can also be dangerous if not handled wisely. When children are constantly praised, they might become overconfident or disconnected from reality. It's important for them to **stay grounded** and remember the values they were raised with. Having a supportive family helps them use their fame for good, rather than letting it affect their mental health or personality.

4. **Do people become famous because of their talent?**

Yes, many people do become famous because of their **genuine talent and hard work**. For example, singers like Arijit Singh or actors like Nawazuddin Siddiqui made it big after years of struggle because of their strong skills and dedication. Talent can definitely help someone stand out in a competitive world.

However, in today's social media culture, some people also gain fame through **viral videos, memes, or controversies**. This type of fame may come quickly, but it

usually doesn't last long. As the saying goes, **"Easy come, easy go."** Real talent, on the other hand, tends to have a lasting impact and earns people respect over time. So while both types of fame exist, the one built on talent is far more valuable in the long run.

Task 05:

3. Describe an intelligent person you know

You should say:

- Who this person is
- How you knew this person
- What this person does
- And explain why you think this person is intelligent

I would like to talk about my father, who is one of the most intelligent people I have ever known.

He worked as a principal in a government school for nearly 30 years, and I've known him, of course, since my childhood. I've seen him handle both personal and professional life with great balance and wisdom.

Even after retiring from his job, he didn't just sit back. Instead, he started his own business, which he is still running successfully today. This shift from education to business shows his adaptability and practical intelligence.

What I really admire is how he explains difficult things in a very simple way. Whether it's life advice, study tips, or even business matters, he always has a logical and clear explanation. He never needed to raise his voice to make a point — his calm nature and meaningful words always did the job.

I remember how students and teachers used to respect him, not just for his knowledge, but also for his fair and supportive behavior. Even now, people often come to him for advice, and he always gives honest and thoughtful suggestions.

I think he is intelligent not just because of his knowledge, but also because of the way he applies it in real-life situations. He is quick to learn, open to new ideas, and

always thinks ahead. That's why I truly consider him one of the most intelligent people I've ever met.

Part 3:

1. Why are some children more intelligent than others?

Well, that's an interesting question. I believe intelligence in children is influenced by a mix of factors. **Firstly, genetics play a role** — some kids are naturally quick learners. But more importantly, the **environment they grow up in matters a lot**. For example, children who are encouraged to ask questions, read books, and explore new things tend to develop better thinking skills.

Let's say one child spends their time watching cartoons all day, while another is encouraged to read storybooks, play with puzzles, or engage in creative activities — naturally, the second child will be more mentally active and possibly appear more intelligent.

Also, the **parenting style and school environment** shape how a child thinks and responds. So, it's not always about being born smart — it's often about **how the brain is nurtured** from an early age.

2. Who do you think plays a more important role in a child's development, teachers or parents?

Honestly, **both parents and teachers have their own crucial roles**, but I would say that **parents lay the foundation** of a child's personality and values. They are the child's first teachers and shape their habits, manners, and emotional behavior — especially in the early years.

For example, a child who grows up in a loving and supportive home is more likely to be confident and emotionally balanced. **Teachers, on the other hand, help the child build academic knowledge, social skills, and discipline**. A good teacher can inspire a child to dream big and work hard.

I remember my own school days when I was struggling with math. It was my teacher who took extra time to help me understand the basics, but it was my parents who encouraged me daily and made sure I stayed motivated. So in short, both are important — it's like two wheels of a bicycle. Without either one, development can't be smooth.

3. Do you think smart people tend to be selfish?

Well, not necessarily. **Being smart doesn't automatically make someone selfish.** In fact, many intelligent people use their knowledge to benefit others. For example, scientists, doctors, and inventors work tirelessly to solve problems and help society.

However, it's also true that **some people may become overconfident or even arrogant because of their intelligence**, which can make them seem selfish. It really depends on the individual's values and upbringing. If someone is smart but humble, they can do wonders for others.

Take someone like Abdul Sattar Edhi — he might not have had a formal degree, but he was incredibly wise and used his intelligence for humanity. On the other hand, we do see some people who use their knowledge only for personal gain. So in the end, **intelligence is a tool, but how it's used depends on the person.**

4. Are smart people happier than others?

That's a thought-provoking question. **Many people assume that being intelligent leads to a happier life**, but that's not always the case. In fact, smart people often overthink or feel misunderstood, especially if they don't find people who relate to them.

Sometimes, **intelligent people carry a lot of pressure** — to succeed, to live up to expectations, or to always have answers. This can cause stress or even loneliness. On the other hand, people with simple lifestyles, who don't overanalyze everything, often live in the moment and enjoy life more.

For example, I've seen some highly educated and smart individuals who are always busy or worried, while a shopkeeper with basic education lives a relaxed and content life. So, **happiness depends more on mindset and lifestyle than just intelligence.**

Task 06:

4. Describe an article on health you read in a magazine or on the Internet

You should say:

- What it was
- Where you read it
- Why you read it
- And how you felt about it

To be honest, I've always been a bit of a curious cat when it comes to health and technology, especially during my academic years. I remember during my final year project, I was diving deep into the world of dermatology and artificial intelligence. I had to read dozens of articles and research papers to find a solid direction for my topic — **you could say I had my nose in a book (well, a screen) 24/7!**

Among all the articles I came across, one particular **research paper on skin disease classification using AI** really stood out like a sore thumb — in a good way. I found it on a medical research portal while looking for reference material, and from the very first paragraph, I knew I had hit the nail on the head.

This article broke down various types of skin diseases and explained how machine learning models — like convolutional neural networks — can be trained to detect and classify them. It was written in such a simple yet scientific manner that it really helped me **connect the dots** between health and technology.

Since I was already working on a project related to this topic, I decided to use that article as my **base paper**. But I didn't just stop there. I **took it up a notch**, made several improvements, added my own findings, and built a much better model. **Long story short**, I ended up writing my own research paper based on that work — and to my surprise, it got published!

That article was a turning point for me. It not only guided my project but also made me realize how technology, when used the right way, can be a **blessing in disguise** for the medical field. I felt a sense of achievement and purpose — like all those sleepless nights had finally paid off.

So all in all, it wasn't just an article. It was more like a **stepping stone** that helped me move from being a learner to becoming a contributor in the field of AI in healthcare.

Part 3:

1. Do you think people are healthier now than in the past?

Honestly, I don't think so. Nowadays, most people are living **life in the fast lane** — always busy, always rushing — which leads to poor eating habits and very little physical activity. Processed and junk food have become a regular part of our diets, and this takes a serious toll on our health.

Even though modern medicine has come a long way, lifestyle diseases like **obesity, high blood pressure, and stress are spreading like wildfire**. People might live longer, but not necessarily healthier.

In contrast, life in the past was much simpler. People used to eat **homegrown, organic food** and walked more instead of relying on cars. So, in my opinion, **health was wealth back then, but now people take it for granted**.

2. How can you tell whether a website is reliable or not?

In my view, a reliable website is one that comes from a **trustworthy source**, like a government body, a hospital, or a reputable news organization such as the BBC or WHO.

If an article is **written by experts** or has proper citations and references, then it holds more weight in my eyes. On the other hand, if the website is full of spelling mistakes, clickbait headlines, or too many pop-up ads, then it's definitely **a red flag**.

For example, during my research project, I relied on websites like PubMed and ScienceDirect because I knew I was getting **facts straight from the horse's mouth** — from the researchers themselves.

3. What activities can schools organize for children to keep fit?

Schools can play a **key role in shaping healthy habits**. They can organize regular **sports events, yoga sessions, martial arts, or even dance classes**. These not only help kids stay fit but also improve their **concentration and mental well-being**.

Even something as simple as morning walks or fun races during lunch breaks can go a long way. In fact, I remember my own school used to have a 'Fitness Friday'

every week where we did different physical activities — and it was something we all looked forward to.

As they say, **“All work and no play makes Jack a dull boy”**, so schools must strike a balance between studies and physical movement.

4. What can governments do to improve people's health?

Governments can do a great deal to **turn the tide** on public health issues. First and foremost, they should **launch awareness campaigns** about the importance of exercise, balanced diets, and regular checkups.

They could also **invest in infrastructure** like public parks, walking tracks, and fitness centers so people have no excuse to stay inactive. Another bold but effective step could be banning junk food advertisements near schools — **nip the problem in the bud**, so to speak.

For example, in countries like Japan and Norway, the government actively promotes health by subsidizing healthy meals and organizing fitness events. It really shows that when the government **puts its foot down**, positive change happens.

Of course, some believe health is a personal matter, and while that's true to an extent, **it takes two to tango** — both personal responsibility and government support are essential.

Task 07:

5. Describe a beautiful sky you enjoyed seeing

You should say:

- Where you saw it
- Who you saw it with
- What you saw
- And how you felt about it

You know, every now and then, life surprises you with a moment that just stops you in your tracks — and for me, that happened a few months ago. Right after my

final exams, I packed my bags and headed off to **Hunza Valley** with my cousins. We were all completely drained from studying — I mean, we'd really been **burning the candle at both ends** — so this trip felt like a lifeline.

We reached Hunza in the afternoon, and honestly, the view was enough to **take your breath away** — snow-covered mountains, fresh air, and absolute peace. But the real highlight was the **evening sky**, which I'll never forget.

That evening, we hiked up to **Eagle's Nest**, which is one of the best sunset points there. As we sat down with a cup of chai in hand, the sky started changing colours — first a soft orange, then pink, and finally this mix of **crimson and violet** that looked straight out of a painting. I remember thinking, *"Man, this is something else."*

It was one of those moments where you just stop and stare — no words, no distractions, just you and nature. Even though we tried to take pictures, they didn't even come close to capturing the beauty of that sky. It was honestly **a sight for sore eyes**, especially after weeks of staring at textbooks.

The whole thing just made me feel so calm — like **time had slowed down**. I was sitting there, soaking it all in, with the cool breeze brushing past. It felt like **all my stress had just melted away**. I don't usually notice the sky much, to be honest, but that one evening really stuck with me.

That sunset didn't just look good — it **hit me right in the feels**. It reminded me how healing nature can be. Since then, I've started spending more time outdoors in the evenings. It's crazy how something so simple can leave **such a lasting impression**.

So yeah, that sky in Hunza — I'd say it was **one of the most beautiful and peaceful moments I've ever experienced**, and it's a memory that'll stay with me for a long time.

Part 3:

1. What kind of people are interested in stars?

In my opinion, people who are naturally curious or a bit dreamy by nature tend to be drawn toward the stars. It's often those who have a **thirst for knowledge** or a **spark of imagination** — scientists, astronomers, poets, or even hopeless

romantics — who love stargazing. Some folks just do it to **clear their head** after a long day — staring at the stars is like pressing the pause button on life. Others are fascinated by what lies beyond our world. I've even met people who keep track of constellations and planets like others follow football scores — that's how passionate they are! I think for many, watching the stars is a way to **escape the hustle and bustle** and feel **grounded and small in the best way possible**.

2. Is high technology helpful for star watching?

Oh, without a doubt! Technology has completely **changed the game** when it comes to star watching. Gone are the days when you needed a giant telescope and a stack of books to figure out what you were looking at. Now, with just a smartphone and an app, you can **pinpoint stars and planets with the tap of a finger**. Some apps even use augmented reality to show you the night sky in real-time — it's like carrying a mini planetarium in your pocket! High-tech telescopes now let amateur star-watchers see distant galaxies that were once only visible to scientists. Honestly, with all these advancements, **stargazing has gone from being a rare hobby to a sky full of possibilities for everyone**.

3. Should kids know more about stars and planets?

Absolutely — in fact, I think it's something that should be **woven into the fabric of early education**. Learning about stars and planets doesn't just teach kids about space — it **opens their minds to the vastness of the universe** and encourages them to dream big. It also helps develop a scientific mindset. After all, today's curious child could be tomorrow's astronaut or astrophysicist. Plus, space is such a fascinating topic — it's a great way to **spark their interest** and get them to ask deeper questions about life, science, and even philosophy. And let's be honest, in a world where screens often rule their attention, a night under the stars can be a **breath of fresh air** — a way to disconnect and reconnect with the natural world.

Task 08:

6. Describe a time when you made a plan to do an activity with a lot of people

You should say:

- What it was
- When and where you made it
- What the activity was
- And explain how you felt about the plan

Alright, so one experience that really stands out was a trip I planned with a bunch of close friends and cousins — it was an adventure that ticked all the boxes for fun, chaos, and pure memories.

It happened last winter, when everyone was back home for the holidays. We were all bored stiff and itching for something out of the ordinary. So, out of the blue, someone casually said, "Let's do something wild — maybe head into the jungle?" At first, we all laughed it off, but soon the idea **caught fire**. Next thing you know, I was taking the lead, pulling the strings, and getting everything sorted.

We chose a jungle spot near a remote riverbank in Punjab. The plan? **Go off the grid** for a couple of days, do some bird hunting, fish by the river, and just explore the raw beauty of nature. Honestly, it was shaping up to be an escape from the daily hustle — and it couldn't have come at a better time.

We set off at the crack of dawn with tents, fishing rods, hunting gear — the whole nine yards. As soon as we reached, the air itself felt different — clean, fresh, and full of life. The jungle was calm but alive, and we were like kids in a candy store, wide-eyed and ready to take it all in.

Once we set up camp, everyone got into action. Some were out hunting birds, others casting lines into the river, and a few of us wandered off to explore hidden trails. It felt like we were living in a different world — no deadlines, no screens, just **good vibes and great company**.

We grilled the fish we caught, shared stories around the campfire, and laughed till our stomachs hurt. Even the tiniest hiccups, like someone stepping into a swamp or struggling to pitch a tent, just added to the charm. It was one of those moments where you truly **live in the now** — no stress, no overthinking, just raw joy.

By the end of the trip, we were all worn out but over the moon. Planning something for a big group isn't always a walk in the park — it's more like **herding**

cats, but when it all falls into place, it's worth every bit of effort. That trip not only brought us closer, but it also reminded me that sometimes, the best memories are made when you **step out of your comfort zone and dive into the wild**.

In short, it was an unforgettable experience — **one for the books** — and if I could do it all over again, I wouldn't change a thing.

Part 3:

1. What kind of plans do young people generally make, and why are these plans important for them?

Young people nowadays often make detailed plans concerning their education, career paths, personal development, and social lives. For instance, a university student might create a weekly study timetable to prepare for exams like the IELTS or GRE. Others may plan fitness routines, budget their expenses, or set goals for learning a new language or skill. These plans help them **stay ahead of the curve** and make the most out of their time.

In today's competitive world, being organized is no longer optional — it's a necessity. As the saying goes, **"If you fail to plan, you are planning to fail."** Planning helps young people manage their priorities, reduce stress, and avoid last-minute chaos.

2. Why can't people always follow their plans?

As much as people try to stick to their plans, life has a way of throwing curveballs. Sudden events such as illness, financial problems, or family obligations can **throw a wrench in the works**. For example, someone might plan a trip during holidays, only to have it canceled due to an unexpected work commitment or a health emergency.

Additionally, many people overestimate their time or underestimate the challenges involved, leading to abandoned plans. While planning is crucial, it's also important to be flexible. Life is unpredictable, and sometimes, you have to **go with the flow** and adapt to changing circumstances.

3. Do you think it's better to plan activities ahead of time or be spontaneous? Why?

That's an interesting question. In most situations, planning ahead is beneficial, especially for activities involving deadlines, travel arrangements, or multiple people. For example, booking flights or accommodation early can save a lot of money and hassle.

However, being spontaneous also has its charm. **Some of the best memories are made when we throw the itinerary out the window and just live in the moment.** Spontaneity can bring a sense of freedom and adventure.

Personally, I believe the best approach is a balance between the two. Plan the major details but leave room for surprises. After all, **life is what happens when you're busy making other plans.**

4. Is it easier to make plans with friends or family? Can you explain why?

In general, making plans with friends is often more straightforward. Since most friends are of a similar age and mindset, coordinating with them is like being **on the same wavelength**. They usually share similar interests and levels of flexibility.

On the other hand, making plans with family can be a bit tricky. Different age groups have different preferences, routines, and responsibilities. For instance, a teenager might want to go hiking, while their parents prefer a quiet resort. These different tastes can make it **feel like herding cats**.

That said, both types of plans can be fulfilling in different ways. With friends, it's more about adventure and fun; with family, it's about bonding and shared experiences.

5. Why do some people constantly change or cancel their plans?

Some people are naturally indecisive or easily distracted. They might be **biting off more than they can chew**, committing to things without considering the time or energy required. Others may suffer from poor time management or lack of motivation.

In some cases, external factors are to blame — work emergencies, health issues, or changes in weather can cause last-minute cancellations. I've seen friends who plan to go to the gym regularly but abandon it halfway due to shifting priorities.

In short, while making a plan is easy, sticking to it requires discipline and adaptability.

6. Are group activities more difficult to plan than solo ones? If so, why?

Absolutely! Planning group activities is like solving a puzzle — every piece has to fit. You need to align everyone's schedules, budgets, and preferences.

Coordinating even a simple dinner can become a major task when dealing with a large group. It often involves countless messages and calls just to **get everyone on board**.

On the contrary, when you plan something solo, you're the captain of the ship. You can make decisions on the fly without waiting for others. That's why solo plans are often more convenient and flexible.

Still, group activities, though harder to organize, are often more enjoyable and create unforgettable memories.

7. Do you think young people enjoy participating in group activities or prefer doing things on their own?

Most young people are social butterflies — they love participating in group activities like team sports, concerts, road trips, or group projects. These activities offer a great way to bond, share laughs, and **make memories that last a lifetime**.

However, there are also those who cherish solitude. They might enjoy reading, writing, painting, or exploring hobbies at their own pace. It really comes down to personality. Extroverts may prefer the energy of a crowd, while introverts might find peace in solo activities.

In my opinion, doing a mix of both is ideal — **too much of anything is never good**.

8. How can good planning skills help someone in their personal or professional life?

Strong planning skills can be a game-changer in both personal and professional life. On the personal front, it helps with time management, budgeting, fitness goals, and maintaining a healthy work-life balance. For instance, someone who meal-preps or sets weekly goals often feels more in control.

Professionally, planning boosts productivity and helps one stay **a step ahead of the game**. Tasks get completed on time, meetings are better prepared for, and long-term projects are executed more smoothly. Employers often value employees who can organize their work effectively and meet deadlines without needing constant supervision.

In short, planning helps avoid chaos and allows individuals to **keep their ducks in a row**.

Task 09:

7. Describe a photo you took that you are proud of

You should say:

- When you took it
- Where you took it
- What is in this photo
- And explain why you are proud of it

One photo that truly warms my heart is a selfie I took with my mother on the day of my engagement. It's not just a picture—it's a memory wrapped in joy, emotions, and unconditional love.

The photo was taken just after the engagement ceremony, when everything was still fresh—the laughter, the congratulations, the sparkle in everyone's eyes. My mother and I were standing together, and someone had just made a light-hearted joke. We looked at each other and smiled, and I spontaneously pulled out my phone and took a selfie.

We were both smiling from ear to ear—**grinning like a Cheshire cat**, you might say. Her eyes were glistening with happiness, and there was a certain pride on her face that I'll never forget. It was as if that one photo captured a thousand unspoken words—love, support, and the unbreakable bond between a mother and her child.

What makes this photo so special to me is the emotion it carries. My mother has been the rock of my life—**always standing by me through thick and thin**. On that day, I could see how truly happy she was to witness such a big milestone in my life. She wasn't just celebrating my engagement—she was celebrating everything we'd been through together.

I'm incredibly proud of this photo because it captures a moment of pure, heartfelt joy. I've framed it and kept it on my desk—it's my daily dose of gratitude. **Every time I look at it, my heart smiles.**

Part 3

1. Why do some people like to record important things with photos?

People like to capture special moments with photos because they help us **freeze time**. One picture can bring back a flood of memories—even years later. For example, a wedding photo can remind someone of the happiest day of their life, or a vacation picture might instantly take them back to that beach sunset.

Photos allow us to **relive the moment** without needing words. In this fast-paced world, they act as **time capsules**. That's why people take so many pictures at birthdays, holidays, or even during simple family dinners. They help us remember not just the event, but also the feelings attached to it.

2. What can people learn from historical photographs?

Historical photographs are like **windows to the past**. They show us how people used to live—their clothing, traditions, homes, and even facial expressions. It's like getting a visual history lesson without opening a book. For instance, a photo from the 1940s might reveal how people dealt with war or how cities looked before modern buildings came up.

These photos also help us **connect the dots** between generations. They allow young people to understand their roots, culture, and how society has changed over time. Sometimes, a single image can **speak louder than a thousand words**.

3. Is taking photos the best way to remember something?

It depends on the situation. While photos are amazing for capturing details, sometimes the best memories come from **living in the moment**. For example, watching a sunset without pulling out your phone might make you feel more connected to nature.

That said, photos are helpful when we want to **look back down memory lane**. I believe a balance is important. If we're always busy clicking pictures, we might miss the real experience. As they say, **not every moment needs a frame**—some should just be felt.

4. Which is better, taking photos or keeping a diary?

Both have their own charm. Photos **show us what we saw**, while diaries **tell us how we felt**. For example, a photo from a trip shows the view, but a diary can describe the cold wind, the excitement, or the funny thing that happened at the train station.

Personally, I prefer a combination. I take photos and also write short notes in a journal, especially when I travel. That way, I can look at the photo and also read the emotions behind it. **Two sides of the same coin**, really.

5. When do people take photos?

Most people take photos during **joyful moments**—like birthdays, festivals, or family reunions. But nowadays, with smartphones, people also take pictures of everyday things—like a beautiful flower, their morning coffee, or even their pet sleeping in a funny pose. It's their way of **finding beauty in the little things**.

Also, some people take photos for social media, to share a piece of their life with others. Whether it's travel, fashion, or food, photos have become a big part of how we communicate and **tell our stories**.

6. Why do some people like to keep old photos?

Old photos are full of **emotional value**. They remind us of people we love, or times that have passed. For example, seeing a picture of your grandparents when they were young or a childhood photo can bring **a tear to the eye and a smile to the face** at the same time.

They also help us reflect on how far we've come. Looking back at old school photos or first job pictures can show how much we've grown, both inside and out.

In short, old photos are not just pictures—they're **precious memories captured in ink and paper**.

Task 10:

8. Describe an object that you think is beautiful

You should say:

- What it is
- Where you saw it
- What it looks like
- And explain why you think it is beautiful

One object that I find incredibly beautiful is a **vintage gramophone** that I came across in an antique store in Lahore about a year ago. I wasn't really looking to buy anything that day—I was just **killing time** while waiting for a friend—but as soon as I laid eyes on that gramophone, I felt like I had discovered something special.

It was placed right in the corner of the shop, almost as if it was shyly waiting for someone to notice it. The first thing that caught my attention was the large, golden brass horn. It had this beautiful shine that reflected the soft light in the shop, making it look almost magical. The base was made of deep mahogany wood with intricate hand-carved designs, the kind of craftsmanship you don't see very often these days. It looked like it belonged in a palace or in an old movie scene.

The shopkeeper noticed my interest and offered to play a record on it. As soon as the music began, I was **transported to another time**. The sound was slightly scratchy, but that only added to its charm. It felt so warm and nostalgic—like listening to the voice of the past. At that moment, I understood why people say, **"Old is gold."**

I think it's beautiful not just because of how it looks, but because of what it represents. It's a symbol of a slower, more intentional lifestyle. Today, we live in a **fast-paced world** where everything is digital and instant. But this gramophone? It

demands patience. You have to gently place the record, set the needle, and wait. And in doing so, it teaches you to **slow down and smell the roses**.

It also made me think of how our grandparents might have listened to music, gathering around in the evening to enjoy a few tunes. It reminded me of my grandfather who loved classical music—seeing the gramophone somehow made me feel connected to him, even though he passed away years ago.

All in all, I believe this object is more than just a piece of furniture or a music player. It's a **work of art**, a piece of history, and a source of emotional connection. That's why, out of everything I've seen, this vintage gramophone stands out as something truly beautiful.

Part 03

1. Do you think there are more beautiful things now than in the past? Why?

Well, in some ways, yes. We now have access to stunning architectural designs, modern cityscapes, and digital art forms that were unimaginable in the past. Technology has brought beauty to our fingertips—literally. However, I also believe that **natural beauty has stood the test of time**. Majestic mountains, serene rivers, and lush green forests are still as captivating as ever. So it really depends on how you define beauty. If you're talking about man-made creations, we've come a long way. But if you're talking about nature, **it's the same old wine in a new bottle**—timeless and irreplaceable.

2. What beautiful scenery spots are there in your country?

Oh, there are plenty! India is a treasure trove of breathtaking places. From the **snow-capped mountains of Himachal and Kashmir**, to the **tranquil backwaters of Kerala**, every corner has its own unique charm. I once visited the **Valley of Flowers in Uttarakhand**, and I felt like I had stepped into a painting. Even the **Thar Desert in Rajasthan**, with its golden sands and traditional architecture, has a beauty that's hard to put into words. **Beauty lies in diversity**, and I think India is a great example of that.

3. Why do you think people create beautiful things?

I believe people create beautiful things to express what words often can't. It's like putting your soul on canvas. Beauty brings joy—not just to the creator but also to those who experience it. Whether it's a painting, a poem, a sculpture, or even a well-designed dress, it reflects emotions, stories, and culture. **As the saying goes, "Art speaks where words are unable to explain."** Creating beauty is also therapeutic. For many, it's a way to find peace in chaos, or to add a splash of color to a grey day.

4. Where do you think people usually come into contact with beautiful things?

Honestly, beauty is everywhere if we choose to see it. People often encounter beauty in nature—a blooming flower, a sunset by the sea, or the first rain of the season. But they also find it in places like **art galleries, music concerts, temples, or even social media feeds**. I once found a street artist painting murals on a dull city wall, and it completely transformed the mood of that street. **Beauty isn't always in grand gestures; sometimes it's hidden in plain sight.**

5. Do people in your country prefer listening to music to appreciating paintings and literature?

Yes, generally speaking, music is more popular these days—mainly because it's so accessible. You can plug in your earphones and listen to music anytime, anywhere. It's like a **quick fix for the soul**. On the other hand, paintings and literature often require time and patience, so fewer people, especially the younger generation, explore them. That said, there's still a niche group that loves poetry, classic literature, and traditional art. It's all about personal taste. Some people like fast food, others enjoy a slow-cooked meal—and both are valid.

6. Why do many people go to scenic spots in person instead of just reading about them in books?

Because **seeing is believing!** Reading about a place can give you knowledge, but **being there gives you an experience**. You can smell the air, feel the breeze, and hear the birds singing. I remember reading about the Taj Mahal as a child, but the first time I saw it in person, I was literally speechless. Books describe things

beautifully, but they can't recreate the feeling of being somewhere in the moment. It's like the difference between reading about chocolate and actually tasting it. You just can't compare the two.

Task 11:

3. Describe a place in your country or part of your country that you would like to recommend to visitors/travelers

You should say:

- What it is
- Where it is
- What people can do there
- And explain why you would like to recommend it to visitors/travellers

- **What it is**

One place in my country that I would highly recommend to visitors is **Hunza Valley**. It's nothing short of a paradise on earth, tucked away in the northern mountains of Pakistan. Hunza is a real **breath of fresh air**, especially for those who are tired of the daily grind and want to escape the concrete jungle. With its majestic peaks, crystal-clear rivers, and welcoming locals, it offers a perfect blend of natural beauty and cultural richness.

- **Where it is**

Hunza is located in **Gilgit-Baltistan**, which is in the far north of Pakistan. It lies along the legendary **Karakoram Highway**, often referred to as the Eighth Wonder of the World due to its height and construction through the world's toughest terrain. The journey to Hunza is an adventure in itself — as you drive along winding mountain roads, every turn **takes your breath away**. It's like flipping through the pages of a living postcard.

- **What people can do there**

There's a **ton of things** to do once you're in Hunza. For starters, you can visit the stunning **Attabad Lake**, which was formed after a landslide in 2010. It's one of those places where you just want to **sit back and soak it all in**. The water is so blue, it looks like someone spilled paint into the valley. Then there's **Altit**

and Baltit Forts, which offer a **glimpse into the past** — standing tall for over 700 years, they're like **time machines** made of stone. Adventure lovers can hike around **Passu Cones**, whose sharp peaks **kiss the sky** and make for jaw-dropping photos. You can also try local dishes like Hunza apricot cake and yak meat stew, which are **a treat for the taste buds**.

- **And explain why you would like to recommend it to visitors/travelers**

The reason I'm so passionate about recommending Hunza is because it has the power to **recharge your batteries** — both physically and emotionally. I went there in **July 2022** with my family, and it was a trip that truly **did wonders for my soul**. The calmness of the valley, the kindness of the people, and the untouched beauty of nature — all of it made me realize how **fast-paced and cluttered** our urban lives have become.

In my opinion, the most important factor is **overall health and mental sharpness**. Some people feel worn out by 55, while others are still active at 70. It should also depend on the **type of profession**—a desk job doesn't drain the body like physical labor does.

Being in Hunza was like **pressing pause** on life. It helped me reflect, reset, and return with a clearer mind. The locals live such a peaceful and simple life — it's **a real eye-opener**. You learn to appreciate the little things: a warm cup of tea with a mountain view, the sound of birds at sunrise, or a friendly smile from a stranger.

Hunza is not just a tourist destination; it's **a journey for the heart and soul**. It leaves a lasting impression, and if you ask me, anyone visiting Pakistan who skips Hunza is truly **missing out** on something magical. It's one of those places that once visited, stays **etched in your memory forever**.

Part 3:

Q: Is it important to take photos while traveling?

Yes, I believe taking photos while traveling is quite important. It's like capturing lightning in a bottle — those fleeting moments that might otherwise fade from memory. Photos allow you to look back and walk down memory lane whenever you want. For example, when I visited Hunza Valley, I took countless photos, and

even today, they bring a smile to my face. That said, some people are so busy clicking pictures that they forget to enjoy the moment — it's like watching a concert through a phone screen. So, in my opinion, while photos are great souvenirs, we should also make time to soak it all in.

Q: Can you trust other people's travel journals on the internet?

Honestly, it's a double-edged sword. Some people share honest, detailed accounts that are incredibly helpful — they might even reveal hidden gems that aren't mentioned in guidebooks. For instance, I once read a blog about a small café in Skardu that turned out to be a slice of heaven. But others post overly filtered experiences just for likes or sponsorships, which can be misleading. So, I think it's best to do your homework, cross-check information, and not take every word as gospel. A bit of skepticism can save you from a lot of disappointment.

Q: What factors affect how people feel about traveling?

There are many moving parts. Budget plays a major role — after all, money doesn't grow on trees. If you're always worried about expenses, it's hard to enjoy the trip. Then comes the company you travel with. Traveling with good friends can be a breath of fresh air, but going with difficult people can turn your holiday into a nightmare in disguise. Weather, personal health, and even your mood at the time can shape your experience. I remember once it rained non-stop during my trip to Murree, and honestly, it put a damper on things. So yes, a mix of internal and external factors really shapes the vibe of your journey.

Q: Will you go to a foreign country to travel because of a distinct landscape?

Yes, absolutely! A unique landscape is often the cherry on top for travel lovers like me. I've always dreamed of seeing the Northern Lights in Norway or the vast deserts of Morocco — places that look like they're straight out of a movie. I think being in such breathtaking environments helps you broaden your horizons and appreciate the diversity of the planet. Plus, it's a chance to step out of your comfort zone and experience something that's not part of your daily life. So yes, I would definitely pack my bags for a foreign land just to witness a once-in-a-lifetime view.

Q: How can tourists have a good travel experience?

Well, a good travel experience doesn't just happen — you have to plan ahead but

stay flexible. First, knowing basic information about the place, like culture, weather, and customs, can help avoid awkward situations. Also, packing smart is key — if you forget essentials, you might find yourself in hot water. I think it's also important to keep a positive mindset. Sometimes things don't go as planned — a delayed flight or a language barrier — but instead of getting frustrated, it's better to go with the flow. And lastly, talking to locals can open doors you didn't know existed — they often give the best advice about where to eat or what to avoid.

Q: What kind of comments do travelers typically leave online after a trip?
Travelers usually leave a mixed bag of reviews. Some people write glowing comments like “beyond expectations” or “would visit again in a heartbeat.” They tend to mention highlights like friendly locals, scenic beauty, or great food. For example, after my trip to Naran, I wrote about a small guesthouse where the owner went above and beyond to make us feel welcome. On the flip side, if something goes wrong — like poor hygiene or bad service — people don't hold back. You'll often see comments like “not worth the hype” or “never again.” Online reviews are a great way to get the lay of the land, but like anything else, they should be read with an open mind.

Task 12:

Part 01:



Topic: Online Shopping (Part 1)

Q1: How often do you buy things online? Why?

Honestly, I shop online quite frequently—probably **once or twice a week**. It's mainly because of the **convenience and variety**. I can explore hundreds of products from the comfort of my home without wasting time in traffic or crowded malls.

Q2: What was the last thing you bought online?

The last thing I purchased online was a **pair of wireless earphones**. I read reviews and compared prices on multiple platforms before choosing one. They were

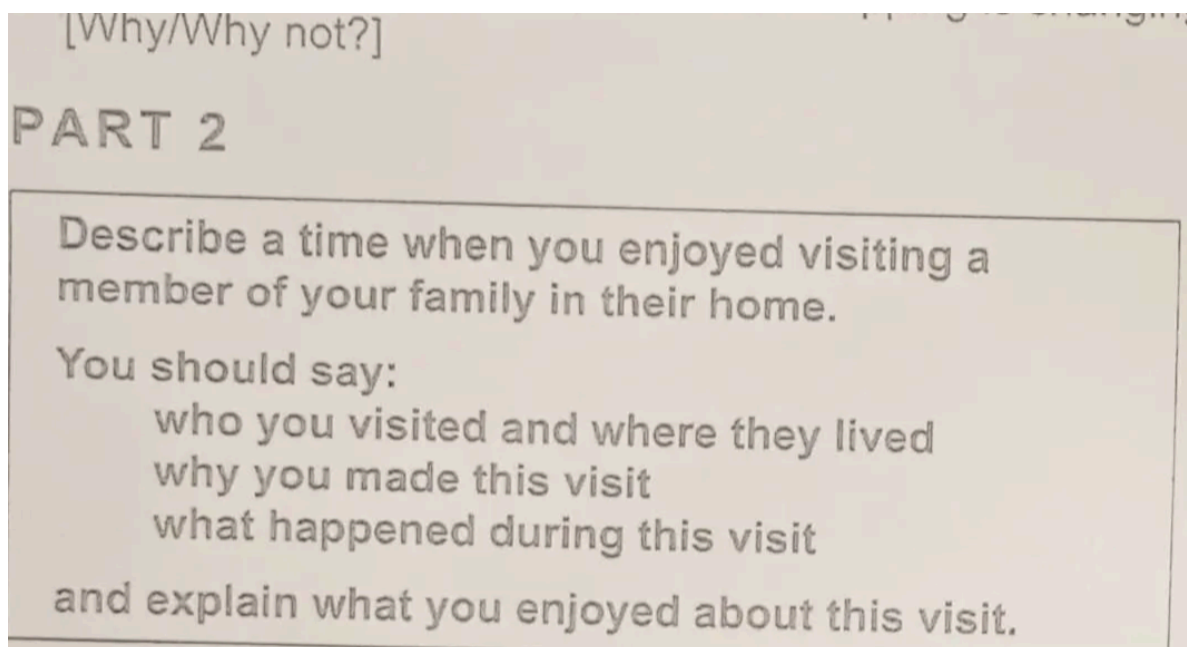
delivered in just two days, which was impressive.

Q3: Do you ever see things in shops and then buy them online? Why/Why not?

Yes, I do that quite often. Sometimes I go to a physical store to **check the quality or size**, but I end up buying it online because it's usually **cheaper** and I can use **discount codes or vouchers**.

Q4: Do you think the popularity of online shopping is changing your town or city centre? Why/Why not?

Absolutely. Many local shops are struggling because people prefer shopping online. Malls and shopping streets are **less crowded now**, and some small businesses have even closed down. It's clear that **e-commerce is reshaping** our shopping habits and urban life.



Well, one memorable time I really enjoyed visiting a family member was when I was invited to my uncle's new home in Islamabad, just after my final exams.

It was perfect timing, honestly—I was completely drained from all the studying and needed a break to unwind and recharge my batteries.

My uncle and his family had recently moved into their new house in a lovely, peaceful area of Islamabad. I had heard a lot about how beautiful their new place

was, and they had been insisting I come visit once my exams were over. So, as soon as I wrapped up my last paper, I packed my bags and took a bus to Islamabad.

From the moment I arrived, I felt so welcome. My aunt gave me a warm hug and served up a delicious lunch—it really hit the spot after all those stressful exam days. Their house was modern and spacious, with large windows that looked out onto the Margalla Hills. The view alone was enough to lift my mood.

During my stay, we did all sorts of fun things. We visited places like Faisal Mosque, Lake View Park, and even went for a short hike in the Margalla Hills. In the evenings, we played board games, watched old family videos, and stayed up late just talking and laughing. It was the kind of quality time that's hard to come by these days.

What I enjoyed most was the feeling of being completely at ease. The stress from my exams seemed to melt away. The atmosphere in their home was so warm and lively—it honestly felt like a home away from home. As the saying goes, *"laughter is the best medicine,"* and I truly felt that throughout the trip.

All in all, it was a wonderful experience that reminded me how important it is to stay connected with family. I came back feeling refreshed, cheerful, and ready to take on new challenges.

Part 03:

FAMILY OCCASIONS

1. When do families celebrate together in your country?

Well, in my country, Pakistan, families usually come together during religious festivals like **Eid-ul-Fitr** and **Eid-ul-Adha**, as well as weddings or even simple get-togethers. These occasions are kind of like glue — they bring everyone closer.

People often travel from different cities just to spend time with their loved ones. Honestly, it's not just about the celebration itself, but also the warmth, laughter, and countless cups of chai that make these moments unforgettable.

2. How often do all the generations in a family come together in your country?

To be honest, it doesn't happen very frequently nowadays because everyone's caught up in the rat race — jobs, studies, and other responsibilities. But when it does happen, it's usually during Eid, weddings, or sometimes even after someone lands a new job or graduates.

Seeing grandparents, parents, and children under one roof is a rare but heartwarming sight — it really brings a sense of belonging and cultural continuity.

3. Why is it that some people might not enjoy attending family occasions?

That's a good question. I believe it depends on personal circumstances. Some people might find family gatherings stressful due to old conflicts, judgments, or even comparisons — like who's doing better in life.

Others may feel out of place if they have a different lifestyle or mindset. I guess it's like the saying, *"You can't choose your family, but you can choose your peace."* So, some just avoid the drama altogether.

EVERYDAY LIFE IN FAMILIES

1. Do you think it is a good thing for parents to help their children with schoolwork?

Absolutely. Parental involvement can make a huge difference in a child's academic success. But there's a fine line — parents should guide, not spoon-feed.

When kids know their parents are backing them, it boosts their confidence. However, it's also important to let children make mistakes and learn on their own. After all, failure is often the best teacher.

2. How important do you think it is for families to eat together at least once a day?

I think it's very important — not just for the sake of food, but for bonding. In today's fast-paced world, dinner might be the only time everyone sits under one roof without screens.

It's a great opportunity to share stories, laugh, and unwind after a long day. As the old saying goes, *"A family that eats together, stays together."*

3. Do you believe that everyone in a family should share household tasks?

Yes, I strongly believe in that. Gone are the days when housework was considered a woman's duty. These days, sharing chores shows respect and teamwork.

Even young kids can contribute in small ways, like tidying up their toys or setting the table. When everyone pitches in, the burden gets lighter and the home becomes a happier place.

Task 13:

34. Describe a friend from your childhood

You should say

- Who she/he is
- When and how you met each other
- What you often did together
- And explain what made you like him/her

Well, when I think about my childhood, one name that instantly pops into my mind is **Muhammad Ali**. He's not my blood relative, but we both belong to the **Gujjar family**, so we share the same caste. In our culture, we call this being "**cost mates**", and even though we're not cousins, we feel as close as family. You could say we've been **thick as thieves** since the day we met.

I first met Ali when I joined school in **5th standard**. Before that, I had been homeschooled, so stepping into a proper classroom felt like being **a fish out of water**. I still remember that day vividly—it was hot, the ceiling fans were barely spinning, and I sat nervously clutching my school bag. Then out of the blue, Ali turned to me and asked if he could **borrow a lead pencil**. That small gesture **broke the ice**, and even though I was a bit of an **introvert**, something about his easy smile made me feel at ease.

As time went on, we started spending more time together. Our bond grew stronger over shared interests and **innocent childhood games**. We used to play with **handmade mud toys and wooden vehicles**, pretending they were real cars—we had **wild imaginations** back then. We'd run barefoot through the fields, play

endless hours of cricket, and chase each other until we were **out of breath but full of joy**. Looking back, those were truly **the good old days**.

What really made me like Ali was his **loyalty and easygoing nature**. Even when we had small fights, he never held a grudge. He had this amazing way of **letting bygones be bygones**. He was the kind of friend who would **stick by your side come rain or shine**, and that meant the world to me.

Now, even though years have flown by, and life has taken us down different paths, we're still in touch. It's amazing to have someone who **knows you inside out**, someone who's seen you at your best and your worst and still stands by you. Childhood friends like Ali are truly **one in a million**, and I feel lucky to have him in my life.

Part 03:

1. Do you still keep in touch with your friends from childhood? Why or why not?

Yes, I'm still in touch with a few close friends from childhood. We grew up together, so the bond we share is really **hard to break**. Even though life has gotten busier and we don't get to meet face-to-face often, we make it a point to stay connected through **WhatsApp and social media**. I feel like childhood friends are **cut from the same cloth**—they've seen you at your best and your worst, and yet they still stick around. In a way, they're like **extended family** to me. Staying in touch with them is like **holding on to a piece of the past** that keeps me grounded.

2. How important is childhood friendship to children?

I believe childhood friendships play a **huge role** in a child's emotional and social development. These friendships teach children how to **share, compromise, trust**, and understand different feelings. They're the first relationships outside of the family where kids learn to deal with arguments, solve problems, and build empathy. And honestly, the joy of **laughing over silly things** with a best friend is **worth its weight in gold**. These memories often become **the building blocks of our personality** and stay with us for life. A true childhood friend is someone who **knows all your secrets but still chooses to stay**.

3. What do you think of communicating via social media?

Social media is definitely a **double-edged sword**. On one hand, it's a blessing for staying in touch, especially when friends or family live far away. A simple message or video call can **bridge the distance in seconds**. But on the other hand, it can sometimes feel a bit **impersonal**—emojis and texts can never fully replace a warm hug or a genuine smile. Still, I'd say it's quite useful for **quick updates**, group chats, and staying informed about what's going on in each other's lives. It's all about how you use it—**don't let the screen build a wall between hearts**.

4. Do you think online communication through social media will replace face-to-face communication?

No, I don't think so. While **online chatting is convenient**, especially in today's fast-paced world, it can't replace the warmth and connection of a real conversation. **Face-to-face communication is the real deal**—you can read body language, tone, and expressions, which are often **lost in translation online**. Human beings are social creatures; we need that real interaction to feel understood and connected. I believe both modes of communication can **go hand in hand**, but one should never completely replace the other.

5. What's the difference between having younger friends and older friends?

Well, younger friends bring a lot of **energy and fresh ideas**. They're fun to be around and often remind you to **not take life too seriously**. On the flip side, older friends usually have more life experience, and they're great at giving **sound advice**. They've often **been there, done that**, so talking to them can be like reading a living book. Personally, I enjoy the balance—**the young ones lift me up**, and the older ones **keep me grounded**. Having both kinds of friends adds richness to my life and broadens my perspective.

6. Has technology changed people's friendships? How?

Yes, it definitely has. Technology has made it easier than ever to **stay in touch across long distances**, which is a great thing. I can catch up with a school friend who's now living abroad just by sending a voice note or joining a group call. However, there's a downside too—some friendships have become **more digital**

than real. People may have hundreds of “friends” online but feel lonely in real life. Also, some prefer texting over meeting in person, which can make relationships feel **a bit shallow**. That said, I use platforms like Facebook and Instagram to **stay connected with like-minded people**, share memories, and support each other’s journeys. So yes, technology has changed the game—**it’s all about finding the right balance**.

Task 14:

Talk about someone much older than you, whom you like very much. Please say

- Who the person is
- How you know him/her
- How long you usually spend with him/her and where
- And explain why you like him/her.

When it comes to someone older whom I truly admire, **without batting an eye**, I’d say my grandfather, **Abdul Hameed**. He’s in his late seventies and is honestly the **backbone of our family**. We live together under one roof, which gives me the precious gift of spending time with him almost every single day—and that’s something I deeply cherish.

He’s a **retired schoolteacher**, and even today, that teacher-like spark in him hasn’t faded one bit. Whether he’s correcting my grammar or sharing a story from history, he does it in a way that makes you hang on every word. He’s like a **walking encyclopedia**, especially when it comes to traditional values and local tales.

What makes my bond with him even more special is the **countryside flavor** he carries with him. He spent most of his life in a small village nestled among green fields and dirt roads, and he often speaks fondly of that simple, peaceful life. He tells me about how people would rise with the sun, draw water from the well, and help one another without expecting anything in return. These stories **paint such a vivid picture** that I feel like I'm right there, chasing cows or flying kites in the wide-open sky.

Every evening, we sit together in the lounge over a warm cup of tea, or sometimes outside under the open sky—just like they do in the village. He shares tales about how he walked miles barefoot to school or how the village came together during weddings and festivals. **Listening to him is like stepping into a time machine**, and I find myself completely absorbed.

One of the things I admire most about him is his **positive outlook on life**. He always says, *"Tough times don't last, but tough people do."* Having seen both the hardships of rural life and the speed of modern times, he still manages to keep his feet firmly on the ground. He's taught me to value hard work, respect elders, and **never look down on humble beginnings**.

Even now, he doesn't sit idle. He never skips his morning walk, often reminding me that "movement is life." He enjoys watering the garden, watching birds, and sometimes just sitting quietly in the courtyard, reflecting on life. I often joke that he's the **wisest man in slippers**.

To wrap it up, having my grandfather around feels like having a **compass in a storm**. His quiet strength, his endless patience, and his warm heart continue to shape who I am becoming. He's not just a grandfather—he's my **mentor, guide, and countryside storyteller**, all wrapped into one. And I can confidently say, **his presence is the kind of blessing that money can't buy**.

Part 03:

♦ 1. What activities do older people like to do in their free time?

Well, older people tend to enjoy activities that bring **peace and a sense of routine**. In the **countryside**, for example, many elders still enjoy tending to small farms, growing vegetables, or looking after animals. It keeps them physically active and

gives them a purpose. My grandfather loves watering the plants every morning—he always says it helps him **start the day on the right foot**.

In cities, older people often prefer **indoor activities** like reading, watching the news, or spending time with their grandchildren. Some elders join walking groups or attend local mosques for prayers and socializing. These little routines are like **medicine for the soul**, helping them stay positive and engaged.

♦ 2. Are there any other activities they find engaging?

Absolutely! With **modern technology reaching even remote areas**, many older people are learning new things. For example, in both urban and rural areas, some elderly individuals now use smartphones to watch religious lectures or talk to relatives living abroad via WhatsApp or video calls. It's amazing to see how they've adapted.

Also, in **rural settings**, elders often gather in the evenings on traditional "charpais" (rope beds) under the open sky to chat and share folk stories. It's a deeply rooted cultural tradition that not only entertains but also **passes wisdom down the generations**.

Some elderly people, especially those who have retired, even take up hobbies like teaching children, birdwatching, or fishing. It shows that even in their later years, they like to **keep the ball rolling** and stay mentally sharp.

♦ 3. Do you think there should be a fixed retirement age? Why or why not?

That's quite a debatable topic. Having a fixed retirement age helps manage workforce transitions and makes room for younger people, especially in **government jobs**. It's like **handing over the reins** to the new generation. For physically demanding jobs, it's also important to ensure the health and safety of workers.

But on the flip side, a **fixed retirement age doesn't always consider individual capabilities**. Some people in their 60s are still full of life and wisdom. In the countryside, many people never "officially" retire—they continue farming or managing family land well into their old age, and it gives them a reason to wake up every morning.

So I believe it should be **more flexible**, allowing people to choose when they want to retire based on their health, job type, and financial condition. After all, **not everyone fits in the same box**.

♦ 4. What factors should the retirement age be based on?

Another factor is **financial stability**. Many rural elders don't get pensions or government support, so they continue working on their lands out of necessity. That's something governments should think about—maybe **adjust retirement policies for rural populations**.

Also, people who **truly enjoy their work**, like teachers, writers, or spiritual scholars, might want to continue contributing. We shouldn't force such people to hang up their boots just because of a number. So, retirement should be about **ability and willingness**, not age alone.

Task 15:

IELTS Speaking Part 2

Cue Card: Describe a good law

You should say:

- what it is
 - who is affected by it
 - and why you think it is good
-

Improved Natural & Detailed Answer:

One law that I personally think is really good and necessary is the **ban on using mobile phones while driving**.

This law has been implemented in many countries, including mine, and it basically means that drivers are not allowed to hold their phones while operating a vehicle. They can't text, scroll through social media, or make calls unless they're using a

hands-free system. In some places, even touching your phone while waiting at a red light can get you a fine.

This law affects pretty much **every single driver** — whether it's someone driving a small car, a truck driver on the highway, or even delivery riders. And beyond that, it **protects pedestrians, cyclists, and passengers**, who are often the victims of accidents caused by distracted drivers.

I think it's a really smart and thoughtful law because these days, **phones are such a huge part of our lives**, and it's so easy to get distracted. I've personally seen people driving while watching TikTok videos or replying to texts, and it's honestly terrifying. Just one second of looking away from the road can cause a serious crash. That really bothers me — I mean, no message or call is more important than a human life.

This law also sends a strong message about **personal responsibility**. Driving is a privilege, not a right. If you're behind the wheel, your full focus should be on the road. I feel **relieved** knowing that this law exists, especially when my family members are out — I want them to come home safe.

Even though not everyone follows it 100%, I still think it has made a difference. People are more cautious now, and they know there are consequences like fines, license points, or even jail time in some cases. In the long run, it promotes **road safety and mindfulness**, which is something every country needs.

IELTS Speaking Part 3

♦ Q1: Do you think laws make our society better?

Opinion:

Yes, without a doubt, I believe laws are the backbone of any well-functioning society.

Reason:

They help define what's acceptable and what's not. If we didn't have laws, people would behave however they wanted — some might be kind and respectful, but others could easily take advantage of the freedom. Laws provide a clear framework that helps maintain order and fairness. They also give people a sense

of security because they know their rights are protected and that there's a system to turn to if something goes wrong.

Consequences:

When laws are respected and properly enforced, society becomes more **organized, peaceful, and just**. People feel safer going about their daily lives. On the other hand, in societies where laws are weak or not respected, you often see higher rates of crime, corruption, and inequality. And that makes people lose trust in their government and the system as a whole.

♦ **Q2: Are people in your country generally respectful of the law?**

Opinion:

That's a tricky one — I'd say there's a mix of attitudes toward the law in my country.

Reason:

Some people genuinely try to follow the rules, especially when it comes to things like traffic laws or paying taxes. But sadly, there are also many who break the law — sometimes because they think they won't get caught, and other times because they simply don't trust the system. Corruption and lack of strict enforcement make it easier for some people to bend the rules without facing serious consequences.

Consequences:

This kind of behavior really damages society in the long run. It creates a feeling of **injustice**, where honest people suffer while those who break the law seem to get away with it. It can also lead to more people ignoring the law altogether, thinking "if they can do it, why can't I?" That mindset is dangerous and can weaken the entire system.

♦ **Q3: Should laws be the same for all age groups?**

Opinion:

I don't think so. I believe laws should be flexible enough to consider a person's age, life experience, and mental maturity.

Reason:

For example, if a 15-year-old and a 35-year-old commit the same crime, treating them exactly the same might be unfair. Teenagers often act out of impulse or peer pressure. They may not fully understand the long-term consequences of their actions. Adults, on the other hand, are generally more aware of right and wrong and should be held more accountable.

Consequences:

If the justice system treats everyone equally without considering age or background, it might **ruin young lives** unnecessarily. But if we adopt a more balanced approach — like offering **rehabilitation programs for minors** instead of just punishment — we give them a chance to learn from their mistakes and become better people. That's how you build a more compassionate and progressive society.

Task 16:

Describe a book you have recently read.

- You should say:
 - what kind of book it is
 - what it is about
 - what sort of people would enjoy it
- and explain why you liked it.

Recently, I read a book called **Atomic Habits** by James Clear, and honestly, it's one of those books that stays in your mind long after you finish it.

It's a **self-improvement and psychology-based book** that focuses on how small, consistent actions can lead to massive results over time. The author calls this the "1% rule" — basically, if you improve just a little bit every single day, those small changes will compound into something huge in the long run.

The book is full of practical strategies. For example, it explains how habits are formed through a four-step process: **cue, craving, response, and reward**. It also introduces the "two-minute rule," which means you start any habit by doing it for just two minutes, making it so easy you can't say no. I found that so relatable

because I often struggle with starting tasks — but once I begin, I usually keep going. Honestly, that tip alone was a real **eye-opener** for me.

I think **anyone who wants to improve their life** would enjoy this book. Students who keep procrastinating, professionals who want to be more productive, or even people who just want to live healthier would find it valuable. The examples are real and inspiring — from Olympic athletes to successful entrepreneurs — so it feels like the advice isn't just theory, it's proven. It really shows that success doesn't happen **overnight**; it's about slow and steady progress.

What I really loved about this book is how **motivated** it made me feel. I remember finishing a chapter and immediately wanting to apply what I'd read. It wasn't just giving me information; it was almost like it was giving me a gentle push, saying, "*Come on, you can do this too.*" That emotional connection is what made it special for me. Honestly, it encouraged me to **hit the ground running** in my own life.

So, overall, I'd say *Atomic Habits* is not just a book, but almost a **blueprint for personal growth** — and I can see myself revisiting it whenever I need a boost in life.

- Follow up part 3 is in part 3 question

Task 17:

Describe some good news you recently received.

- You should say:
- what the news was
- how you received the news
- who gave it to you

and explain why this was good news.

A few weeks ago, I received some really wonderful news that honestly made my day — I found out that I had been accepted for a **university exchange program** abroad.

I actually got the news through an **official email** from the university. I remember I was casually checking my inbox in the evening, not expecting anything important,

when I saw the subject line: *"Congratulations on your acceptance."* My heart started racing, and I opened it immediately. It was one of those moments where you have to **read it twice** just to make sure it's real.

The news came from the **international office** of my university, and they also attached all the details — the university I'd be attending, the courses I could take, and even the tentative dates for departure. I instantly called my parents to share the news, and I could hear the pride and happiness in their voices. My mom even said, *"This is a dream come true,"* which made the moment even more special.

This news meant a lot to me because I've always wanted to study in a different country, experience a new culture, and meet people from around the world. Getting selected for this program felt like all my hard work and late nights had finally paid off. It was a real **feather in my cap**.

What I loved most about this news was the sense of possibility it brought. Suddenly, my future felt more exciting and open. I was already imagining walking on a new campus, exploring new cities, and making memories that would last a lifetime. Honestly, it felt like a fresh chapter of my life was about to begin, and I was ready to **hit the ground running**.

Part 3:

1. Why is receiving good news important for people?

I firmly believe receiving good news is like *a breath of fresh air* in our hectic lives. It's not just about the information itself — it's about the emotional lift it gives us. Good news can act as a natural stress reliever, increasing dopamine levels in the brain and making us more optimistic. For example, in the workplace, when an employee hears they've been promoted, it motivates them to work even harder and builds a sense of loyalty to the company. In education, hearing that you've passed an important exam can boost confidence and encourage further learning. On a personal level, receiving good news like a friend recovering from illness can strengthen emotional connections. In short, *good news puts the wind in our sails*, helping us navigate life's challenges with more positivity and energy.

2. What kind of good news do people usually share with others?

In most cultures, people love to share milestones, achievements, and life-changing events. This could range from academic success — like getting a scholarship — to professional achievements such as landing a dream job or starting a business. In personal life, people share news about engagements, marriages, or even something as simple as buying a new car. Sports fans share victories of their favorite teams, while in creative industries, artists might announce their latest exhibitions or book releases. Sharing good news is *a way of spreading sunshine*; it strengthens bonds because it allows others to take part in our happiness. Even in difficult times, small pieces of good news — such as a medical improvement or financial relief — can be like *a ray of hope in a cloudy sky*.

3. How do people in your country usually react to good news?

In Pakistan, reactions to good news are often full of warmth and hospitality. People don't just say "congratulations" — they express it with actions. It's common to distribute sweets, host dinners, or invite relatives and friends over. For example, when someone's child gets high grades in board exams, they might invite close relatives for a celebratory meal. In workplaces, colleagues might bring cake or snacks to share the joy. This is tied to our collectivist culture where *joy shared is joy doubled*. Even small news, like getting a driving license, can be celebrated in a big way. It reflects the deep cultural value placed on community support and collective happiness.

4. Do people prefer to hear good news or bad news first?

This really depends on personality, but I think many people prefer hearing good news first because it's easier on the heart and *sets the tone on a positive note*. For example, in workplaces, managers sometimes start meetings by announcing a success story before discussing problems — this boosts morale and makes people more receptive to criticism. On the other hand, some individuals adopt a *"rip the band-aid off"* approach, preferring to hear bad news first so they can deal with it immediately and then end on a positive note. In my case, I prefer good news first because it energizes me and makes me mentally stronger to handle any negatives that follow.

5. How can people thoughtfully deliver good news?

Delivering good news thoughtfully requires *reading the room*. Timing is crucial — announcing a promotion to someone who is grieving might not be appropriate, even if your intentions are good. The tone should be warm but not boastful, and it's nice to make it personal. For instance, instead of saying "I got promoted" bluntly, you could say "I have something exciting to share with you — I've been promoted, and your advice really helped me get here." This not only shares your joy but also makes the other person feel valued. Using a handwritten note, a surprise gathering, or even a heartfelt phone call can make the moment memorable. *It's not just the news, but the way you wrap it up that counts.*

6. Do people react differently to good news depending on their personality?

Absolutely, personality plays a big role. Extroverted people often react *like fireworks*, showing excitement openly through cheers, hugs, or even dancing. They might post on social media immediately to share their happiness with a wider circle. Introverts, on the other hand, might prefer a quiet celebration, like having a small dinner with close friends. Some people are naturally humble, so they downplay their successes, while others enjoy being in the spotlight. In professional settings, personalities matter too — a reserved boss might just give a polite smile when told of a success, while a more expressive leader might throw an impromptu office party. This shows that *we don't all dance to the same tune* when it comes to celebrating.

Task 18:

Describe your favorite shop.

You should say:

- where it is
- how often you go there
- what it sells
- and explain why you think it is a good shop

One of my absolute favourite shops is a fascinating little place called *The Heritage Vault*, located in the old quarter of my city. It's hidden away on a narrow cobblestone street, almost *like stepping back in time* when you first see it. From the outside, it doesn't look very big, but once you walk in, it feels like *Aladdin's cave* — full of treasures from different eras.

I usually visit this shop about once every couple of months, though I could easily spend hours there each time. The owner knows me quite well now, because I often come in just to browse and take in the atmosphere, even if I don't buy anything. It's not your typical shop — it's more like a small-scale museum where everything is for sale.

They carry an incredible collection of antique musical instruments, from hand-carved sitars and vintage gramophones to traditional drums that still produce the richest, warmest tones. In another section, you'll find beautifully preserved historical furniture — things like intricately carved wooden chairs, brass lamps, and cabinets that look like they belong in a royal palace. But what really captures my imagination is the section dedicated to old war tools — swords with ornate handles, polished shields, finely crafted bows and arrows, and even axes that look like they've seen real battles. Holding one of these weapons makes you feel the weight of history in your hands — *it's like touching the past*.

What makes this shop so special for me is not just the items themselves, but the stories behind them. The owner is a real history enthusiast, and he can tell you the origin of almost every piece — whether it's from a forgotten battlefield or a famous musician's collection. I think that's *the icing on the cake*, because it transforms the experience from simple shopping into a journey through time.

In my opinion, *The Heritage Vault* is a good shop because it's preserving history while making it accessible to ordinary people. It's a place where culture, craftsmanship, and curiosity come together under one roof. Every visit leaves me inspired, and I always walk out feeling like I've learned something new about the world and its past.

Part 3:

1 Do you think people today enjoy hobbies as much as in the past?

- **General** → In my view, hobbies are still enjoyed but in a different way compared to before.
 - **Compare** → In the past, people often engaged in outdoor or hands-on hobbies, whereas now many prefer digital or technology-based activities.
 - **Predict** → I think in the future, hobbies will become even more virtual, possibly involving AI and VR experiences.
 - **Opinion** → Personally, I believe traditional hobbies have more benefits for mental and physical well-being than purely digital ones.
-

2 Why do some people stop doing their hobbies when they grow older?

- **General** → Many people give up hobbies as they age due to changes in lifestyle or priorities.
 - **Compare** → For example, young adults might have more time and energy, but older people may focus more on work or family responsibilities.
 - **Predict** → In the future, as work-life balance improves, more older adults might continue hobbies throughout life.
 - **Opinion** → I feel hobbies are essential at every age because they help reduce stress and keep the mind active.
-

3 Do you think schools should encourage students to have hobbies?

- **General** → Yes, schools can play a big role in helping students develop hobbies.
 - **Compare** → Unlike academic subjects, hobbies allow creativity and personal expression.
 - **Predict** → If schools keep supporting extracurricular activities, students will grow up with better social skills and emotional health.
 - **Opinion** → In my opinion, hobbies in school should be valued as much as academic learning because they shape personality.
-

4 Are hobbies today more expensive than in the past?

- **General** → In many cases, yes, hobbies today can be more costly.

- **Compare** → Traditional hobbies like reading or painting used fewer resources, but modern hobbies like gaming or photography often require expensive equipment.
 - **Predict** → With technology advancing, some hobbies may become even pricier, although online resources could also make certain hobbies cheaper.
 - **Opinion** → I think a hobby doesn't need to be expensive to be enjoyable — creativity matters more than cost.
-

5 How do hobbies influence a person's career or work life?

- **General** → Hobbies can positively impact a person's professional life.
- **Compare** → For example, problem-solving skills from chess or teamwork from sports can be applied at work.
- **Predict** → In the future, employers might consider personal hobbies when hiring, as they reflect personality and soft skills.
- **Opinion** → I believe hobbies are a hidden asset that can make someone more well-rounded and adaptable in their career.

Task 19:

Describe a vocation you think is useful to society.

You should say:

what it is

what it involves

what kind of people usually do this work

and explain why you think it is useful to society.

If I had the chance, I would definitely choose the **medical field**, because it gives me the opportunity to rescue people and save lives. For as long as I can remember, I've felt a strong pull towards helping others, especially in moments when they need it the most. To me, standing between life and death for someone, and being able to give them a second chance, is one of the greatest things a human being can do.

Helping people in their most critical moments has always been my biggest motivation. I see medicine not only as treating illnesses, but also as giving people **hope and comfort** when they feel vulnerable. It's a bit like being a lighthouse during a storm — guiding people through pain and uncertainty. This deep sense of purpose pushes me to work hard, keep learning, and dedicate myself to humanity.

One of my strongest motivations is to act as a **first responder** in emergencies. I wouldn't just want to sit in a hospital ward; I would want to be there on the spot — whether it's a road accident, a sudden collapse at home, or even a natural disaster. I truly believe that the right help at the right moment can turn a tragedy into a survival story.

Another reason is the sense of fulfilment this vocation brings. Medicine is really where **science meets compassion**. It's not just about diagnosing or prescribing medicine; it's also about holding someone's hand when they're scared, reassuring their families, and being a source of strength when everything feels uncertain. Sometimes, even a few kind words can heal as much as medicine itself.

Of course, I know this road is **no bed of roses** — it means years of study, sleepless nights, and continuous training. But as the saying goes, **nothing worth having comes easy**. For me, the reward of seeing someone recover, and knowing that I played even a small part in that journey, is truly priceless.

So, in a nutshell, my passion for helping others, my motivation to rescue people in need, and my belief that every life is worth fighting for are the reasons I see medicine as one of the most useful vocations to society. For me, it's not just a job — it's a lifelong mission.

Part 03:

1. Do you think vocational training is as important as university education?

Absolutely. I believe vocational training is just as important as university education because it equips people with hands-on skills that are directly

applicable in the workplace. For instance, a skilled electrician or mechanic can start earning a living right away without spending years in academic study. As the saying goes, "Not everyone's cut out for the ivory tower" — some people thrive in practical environments rather than theoretical ones. Moreover, many industries rely heavily on skilled trades, and without them, society would grind to a halt. So, in my opinion, both pathways hold equal value, just in different ways.

2. How has vocational training changed in recent years?

Vocational training has evolved tremendously in the past decade. Nowadays, it's not just about manual trades — it includes high-tech fields like coding, digital marketing, and renewable energy systems. I'd say technology has really turned the tables, making training more interactive through online simulations and virtual reality. Furthermore, many vocational programs now collaborate closely with industries, which means students hit the ground running when they graduate. In short, the stereotype that vocational training is outdated has been completely thrown out the window.

3. Do you think schools should offer more vocational courses?

Without a doubt. In my view, schools should integrate more vocational courses into the curriculum because not every student learns best through books and lectures. Giving teenagers a chance to explore carpentry, culinary arts, or computer repair could help them find their true calling. As the saying goes, "Different strokes for different folks" — academic subjects suit some, while practical skills suit others. Plus, introducing vocational courses early could reduce unemployment by preparing students for jobs that are actually in demand.

4. What kinds of vocational skills will be most important in the future?

I think the future will demand a blend of traditional and cutting-edge skills. On one hand, technical skills like plumbing, electrical work, and construction will always be bread and butter jobs, because machines can't fully replace them. On the other hand, skills in IT, renewable energy, and healthcare will be the name of the game, as technology and an ageing population drive demand. People who can wear many hats — combining technical expertise with problem-solving — will have the upper hand in the job market.

5. How do vocational skills contribute to the economy?

Vocational skills are the backbone of any economy. Skilled workers keep industries running smoothly, whether it's maintaining infrastructure, building homes, or delivering healthcare. Every time a plumber fixes a leak or a chef opens a restaurant, money circulates and jobs are created. In fact, countries with strong vocational sectors often enjoy lower unemployment rates because people can earn a crust without necessarily going to university. It's fair to say that without skilled trades, economic growth would hit a brick wall.

Task : 20:

Describe someone you respect.

You should say:

who the person is

how you know about this person

what this person does

what this person is like

and explain why you respect this person.

I am living in a close-knit family with my parents and one sibling—my elder brother. Honestly speaking, he is not just my brother, but also a guiding light in my

life. He has always stood by my side through thick and thin, and I feel blessed beyond words to have him.

My elder brother is a businessman. Life has not always been a bed of roses for us, but he shouldered every responsibility with courage and determination. He has been like a pillar of strength for our whole family. What makes him special to me is that he not only guided me in every walk of life but also sponsored my education. From school to university, he bore all my educational expenses without ever letting me feel like a burden. To me, that is not just generosity—it is pure love and sacrifice.

Personality-wise, he is extremely kind, humble, and down-to-earth. He is more responsible than he actually needed to be. In fact, I often feel that he has played the role of a father rather than just a brother. Whenever life threw challenges at me, he was always there, lifting me up and reminding me that “every cloud has a silver lining.” His wisdom, patience, and determination inspire me to keep moving forward no matter what.

I respect him deeply because he embodies the true meaning of family devotion. He never thinks about himself first; instead, he always puts the needs of others before his own. There’s a saying that “blood is thicker than water,” and my brother is living proof of that. For me, he is not only my role model but also my best friend, my mentor, and my biggest cheerleader.

In short, my elder brother is the person I respect the most because he has shaped my life in countless ways. I truly look up to him, and I pray that one day I can be as selfless and strong-hearted as he is.

Part 03:

Q1: In your country, which people are respected the most?

Well, in my country, I think people who serve society in one way or another are respected the most. For instance, teachers hold a special place because they shape the future of the young generation. There’s even a saying in our culture, “*A teacher is like a spiritual parent.*” Similarly, doctors are highly valued because they save lives, and in times of crisis, they are seen as real heroes. On the other hand, elders in the family are always given respect, no matter what, because of their

wisdom and life experiences. I personally feel that respect is not only about profession but also about character—someone who is honest, helpful, and down-to-earth earns people's admiration naturally.

Q2: Do you think younger people should respect older people only because of age?

Not really. I believe respect should be earned through actions, not just granted automatically because of age. Of course, in my culture, respecting elders is considered *part and parcel* of good manners, and I completely agree with that to some extent. However, if an elder person behaves rudely or unfairly, blind respect doesn't make sense. For example, I've met some older people who are incredibly kind and supportive—they deserve all the respect in the world. But if someone misuses their age to dominate others, then the saying "*Respect is a two-way street*" comes to my mind. So, in my opinion, respect should be based on both age **and** the way a person behaves.

Q3: What qualities make people respected at work?

At the workplace, respect is usually linked with professionalism and leadership qualities. For instance, if a manager leads by example, treats employees fairly, and appreciates their hard work, then automatically people respect him or her. "*Actions speak louder than words*," so a boss who works hard instead of just giving orders will always be admired. I've seen some colleagues who don't have very high positions, but they are so cooperative, always ready to lend a hand, that everyone respects them. So, qualities like honesty, responsibility, communication skills, and empathy are the real building blocks of respect in professional life.

Q4: Is respect more important than money in today's world?

That's a very interesting question. Personally, I think respect is priceless. You can earn millions, but if people don't value you, then deep down you'll feel empty. There's an old proverb that says, "*Money makes the mare go, but respect makes the man grow*." For example, some businessmen are very rich, but because of unethical practices, nobody truly respects them. On the other hand, people like social workers or teachers might not be rich, but they live in people's hearts

forever. Of course, money is essential for survival, but in the long run, respect gives you peace of mind and dignity, which money alone can't buy.

Q5: Do you think in the future people will respect the same things they do today?

I feel the definition of respect will keep changing with time. Right now, traditional professions like doctors, teachers, and leaders get the most respect. But in the future, I believe people will respect innovation, creativity, and problem-solving more. For instance, tech experts, environmental activists, or even influencers who use their platform positively might become the new role models. However, one thing will never change—basic human values. Kindness, honesty, and responsibility will always remain the backbone of respect. As we say, *"Times change, but principles don't."*

Task 21:

- Part 1: Weather:

Describe a time of the day you like.

You should say:

what time of day it is

what you do at that time

who you are usually with

and explain why you like it.

I am an early riser. I usually wake up just before the Fajar prayer call, and honestly, that time of the day feels like pure magic to me. The world is still fast asleep, but I get this priceless silence and calmness that you can't buy with money. For me, those early hours are the most productive ones. I often dedicate that time to working on my personal projects, and sometimes I even dive deep into research for my Master's studies.

Usually, I'm alone during that time, and I actually enjoy that solitude. It's like the whole universe has pressed the pause button, giving me a golden chance to focus

without distractions. Occasionally, I spend a few minutes talking to my parents when they wake up for prayer, and that adds a beautiful spiritual touch to the morning.

The reason I like this time so much is that it sets the tone for the entire day. You know, people often say *"Well begun is half done"*, and I truly believe in that. When I start my day early, with prayer, a bit of reading, and some personal work, I feel like I've already achieved something before the sun even rises. That inner satisfaction carries me through the rest of the day.

Another thing I love about this time is the atmosphere. The air feels fresher, birds start chirping, and the first light of dawn has this soothing, almost poetic quality. It always reminds me of hope and new beginnings. No matter how stressful yesterday was, a new dawn always whispers that today is another chance.

So yes, without a shadow of a doubt, the early morning, just before and after the Fajar prayer, is the time of the day I cherish the most. It's not just a habit anymore—it's more like a lifestyle that gives me clarity, peace, and motivation.

Part 03:

1. Do you think mornings are better than evenings for work and study?

Well, I strongly believe mornings are far more productive than evenings, especially for tasks that require focus and creativity. In the early hours, the world is quieter, the mind is fresh, and there are fewer distractions. For instance, I usually wake up before dawn, and that time allows me to dive into my research without being disturbed by phone calls or social media. Evenings, on the other hand, are often crowded with family responsibilities and social obligations, so I feel mornings give me a head start on the day.

2. Why do some people prefer working at night rather than in the morning?

That's an interesting question. I think it depends on an individual's body clock. Some people are naturally night owls; they feel more energetic and creative when the world is asleep. For example, many artists, writers, and even IT professionals

tend to work late at night because they find inspiration in silence and solitude. On the other hand, some people may have no choice but to work at night due to job requirements, like doctors or security personnel. Personally, I feel mornings suit me better, but I can see why others might find nights more appealing.

3. How has people's daily routine changed compared to the past?

Life has changed dramatically over the past few decades. In the past, people used to follow a very disciplined lifestyle—going to bed early and waking up with sunrise. But now, due to technology and a fast-paced lifestyle, routines are much more irregular. For instance, young people often stay up late scrolling on their phones or watching Netflix, which was unimaginable for our grandparents. Work culture has also shifted—remote work and flexible hours mean people's schedules are more scattered than ever before. This change reflects modern opportunities but also comes with drawbacks, such as lack of sleep and declining health.

4. Do you think people nowadays get enough sleep? Why or why not?

Honestly, I don't think so. Most people today are sleep-deprived because of busy schedules and digital distractions. Social media is one of the biggest culprits—it keeps people awake past midnight. Students also struggle, as they often burn the midnight oil preparing for exams. Even working professionals compromise their rest to meet deadlines. Lack of sleep has become so normal that people forget how crucial it is for mental and physical health. Personally, I try to protect my sleep schedule because I know it directly affects my productivity and mood.

5. How important is it for children to have a routine?

I would say it's absolutely vital. A proper routine helps children develop discipline, time management, and even emotional stability. For example, if a child goes to bed and wakes up at fixed times, they tend to perform better at school and are less cranky during the day. Without a routine, children often waste time, become restless, and find it hard to focus. I believe that parents play a huge role in instilling these habits early on, because once a routine becomes second nature, it sets the foundation for a successful and balanced life.

1. Why do some people prefer mornings while others prefer evenings?

Well, I believe it all boils down to personal rhythm and lifestyle. Some people, like me, are early risers who feel that the morning offers a fresh start — the mind is uncluttered, the environment is peaceful, and productivity comes naturally. On the other hand, many people are night owls, they find inspiration in the calm of the evening, when distractions are fewer and creativity seems to flow better. For example, I have a close friend who paints only at night because she feels the silence fuels her imagination. So, in short, preferences are shaped by both biological clocks and personal habits.

2. Do you think people nowadays have less free time than in the past?

Absolutely, yes. With the pace of modern life, people are constantly juggling work, studies, and family responsibilities. In the past, life was simpler — people worked fewer hours and had stronger community bonds, so leisure was more accessible. Nowadays, even during free hours, many people are glued to their phones or stuck finishing office tasks from home. For instance, my elder brother, who runs a business, often brings his work home, which eats away at his family time. This really shows how the boundaries between work and personal life are fading away.

3. Do you think it's important to have a daily routine? Why or why not?

Yes, having a daily routine is extremely important because it brings discipline and structure to life. A routine ensures that we strike a balance between work, rest, and personal growth. Personally, I stick to a morning schedule, where I devote the first few hours to my studies and research, and that gives me a sense of control over my day. Without a routine, I feel people often drift aimlessly, wasting precious time. That being said, I also think a routine shouldn't be too rigid — some flexibility is needed to enjoy life's little surprises.

4. Do older people and younger people spend their free time differently?

Yes, there's definitely a contrast. Older people usually prefer calm and traditional activities like gardening, reading newspapers, or spending time with grandchildren. Younger people, on the other hand, often lean towards digital entertainment — social media, online gaming, or going out with friends. For instance, my father enjoys listening to the radio early in the morning, while my

younger cousin can't imagine starting his day without checking Instagram. These differences simply reflect generational gaps in lifestyle and technology use.

5. How has technology changed the way people spend their free time?

Technology has completely revolutionized leisure activities. On the positive side, it has made entertainment more accessible — streaming platforms, online classes, even fitness apps have opened doors to new hobbies. For example, during COVID, I attended online music sessions and discovered new interests, which wouldn't have been possible otherwise. But on the flip side, excessive reliance on technology has reduced physical activities and face-to-face interactions. Many people now prefer scrolling endlessly instead of meeting friends in person. So, while technology has enriched free time in some ways, it has also taken away the simplicity of real-world connections.

Task = 22:

Describe a sports you would like to learn.

You should say:

what it is

what equipment is needed for it

how you would learn it

and explain why you would like to learn this sport.

Well, I would really like to learn *judo karate*. In fact, I have already taken the first step towards it, because I started practicing it about a week ago.

To begin with, this sport doesn't need a lot of fancy equipment. The most essential things are a proper uniform, which is usually called a *gi*, a belt that shows your level, and of course a safe mat to practice on. Some people also use gloves and protective gear, but the real strength comes from discipline and training rather than heavy equipment.

As for how I would learn it, I have already joined a local training center where an instructor guides us through the basic moves. Right now, I am at a beginner's stage, but I can already feel the difference. The training usually starts with warm-

ups, then practicing stances, punches, and defensive blocks. I also watch online tutorials to revise at home and keep a regular practice routine.

The main reason I want to learn judo karate is not for fighting with someone, but mainly for *self-defense* and *fitness*. These days, it is very important to know how to protect yourself, especially in unexpected situations. Apart from that, this sport has a positive influence on my daily life. Since I started learning, I have noticed that I have become more productive. Laziness is slowly melting away, and I feel more energetic throughout the day. It also helps me stay motivated, avoid unhealthy food, and maintain a healthy lifestyle.

Overall, judo karate is not just a sport for me, but a way to improve my physical fitness, mental focus, and personal discipline. I believe if I continue practicing, I will not only master self-defense skills but also become a healthier and more confident person.

Part 03:

1. Do you think children should learn a sport from a young age?

Yes, absolutely. Sports at a young age not only build physical strength but also shape discipline and teamwork. For example, when a child learns karate, it's not just about fighting — it teaches them respect, focus, and self-control. These lessons naturally spill over into academics and daily life, so I think the earlier they start, the better their growth.

2. What qualities can people develop through sports?

Sports develop resilience, patience, and the habit of consistency. In martial arts particularly, you learn to face setbacks calmly — maybe you lose a match today, but it motivates you to train harder tomorrow. This mindset is valuable because life itself is full of challenges, and people who do sports tend to bounce back faster instead of giving up.

3. How do sports influence people's daily routines?

From my personal experience, sports completely reshape your routine. Since I started practicing karate, I became more disciplined with my time. Laziness melted away because I had to follow a structured plan. Even my diet improved naturally —

I stopped eating junk food because I knew it would affect my performance. So, sports don't just keep you fit, they change your lifestyle in a positive way.

4. Do you think individual sports are better than team sports?

I wouldn't say one is better than the other; they just build different skills. Individual sports like karate teach you self-reliance and inner discipline, while team sports like football enhance communication and cooperation. Ideally, a balanced exposure to both types makes a person more well-rounded.

5. How can governments encourage people to participate in sports?

Governments can create more accessible sports facilities, sponsor local tournaments, and highlight role models in media. If young people see successful athletes who came from humble backgrounds, they feel inspired. Personally, I think schools should integrate self-defense sports like karate into the curriculum — it improves both safety and confidence, especially for youth.

Q1. Do you think people nowadays have less time for physical activities compared to the past?

Answer (Band 9 style):

Yes, absolutely. In today's fast-paced lifestyle, people are often tied to desk jobs and digital devices. Unlike the past, when people were naturally more active through walking or manual work, modern life is dominated by screens. However, I believe it's not just about having less time, it's also about priorities. Many people spend hours scrolling on social media but claim they are too busy to exercise. So, I would say it's more of a lifestyle choice than just a lack of time.

Q2. What role do sports play in building a healthy society?

Answer:

Sports play a pivotal role in shaping a healthy and disciplined society. Firstly, they improve physical health and reduce lifestyle diseases like obesity. Secondly, they promote teamwork, discipline, and resilience, which are values that extend beyond the playground. In fact, countries that invest in sports culture often see their youth more engaged, less distracted by unhealthy habits, and more focused on their goals. So, sports are not just about fitness, they are about nation-building as well.

Q3. Do you think children should be encouraged to take part in competitive sports?

Answer:

Yes, definitely. Competitive sports teach children how to handle pressure, success, and even failure in a constructive way. These lessons are invaluable in real life. Of course, the emphasis should be on learning and growth, rather than just winning medals. If competition is balanced with fun, it helps children become more confident, disciplined, and emotionally strong.

Q4. How can governments encourage people to adopt a more active lifestyle?

Answer:

Governments can take multiple measures. For example, they can build more public parks, sports complexes, and cycling tracks to make physical activity accessible. They can also run awareness campaigns about the dangers of a sedentary lifestyle. Moreover, integrating physical education into school curriculums and offering incentives, like discounts on gym memberships or tax benefits for companies that promote fitness, could also be effective.

Q5. Do you think technology has had a positive or negative impact on sports and fitness?

Answer:

I think it's a double-edged sword. On the positive side, fitness apps, smartwatches, and online training programs make exercise more personalized and engaging. People can track their progress and stay motivated. On the negative side, technology also promotes laziness—streaming platforms and gaming keep people sitting for hours. So, it all depends on how wisely technology is used.

Task 23:

Describe a time when you helped someone.

You should say:

Who you helped

How you helped them

Why you helped them

And explain how this experience made you feel:

One unforgettable moment when I helped someone was during a devastating flood in my city. I am an *internationally certified rescue volunteer*, so I was actively involved in relief operations.

During one of the rescue missions, my team and I spotted a young girl trapped on the roof of a small house. The water level was extremely high, and the surrounding area was completely flooded. At first, we almost lost hope of reaching her because the current was strong and the water was too shallow for our rescue boat to move easily.

As the team leader, I decided to take the risk myself. I put some heavy stones on the boat to stabilize it, checked my personal protective equipment, and carried an extra life jacket for the victim. Honestly, it felt like a life-and-death decision, but I told myself that saving her was worth every risk.

When I finally reached her, she was nearly unconscious due to fear and exhaustion. Somehow, with great effort, I managed to get her safely onto the boat. After about 45 minutes of struggling against the water, I finally brought her back to the rescue station.

That day left a deep impact on me. I don't just consider it a rescue mission — I consider it a blessing from God, a kind of *earning for the life hereafter*. It reminded me how valuable even a single life is, and it strengthened my motivation to continue helping others whenever I can.

Part 03:

1. Do you think helping others is important?

Absolutely, helping others is extremely important because it not only supports people in difficult times but also builds stronger communities. For example, when people volunteer or even perform small acts of kindness, it creates a sense of trust and cooperation in society. Personally, I believe the true value of life is

measured by how much we contribute to others, not just by what we achieve individually.

2. In what ways can people help each other in daily life?

Helping doesn't always have to be dramatic, like rescue missions. It can be as simple as offering guidance to a colleague, teaching a classmate before exams, or even helping an elderly person cross the road. In daily life, these small gestures may seem ordinary, but they can make a huge difference to someone's confidence, comfort, or happiness.

3. Do you think people nowadays are less willing to help others than in the past?

That's a very interesting question. I think in some ways, yes — because modern life has made people busier and more focused on their personal goals. However, technology and social media have also created new ways to help, such as online fundraising, awareness campaigns, or volunteering through digital platforms. So, while the form of helping may have changed, the spirit of helping is still alive.

4. How do schools and universities encourage students to help others?

Educational institutions play a huge role in shaping young minds. Many schools organize community service programs, blood donation camps, or disaster relief drives. Universities often encourage group projects where teamwork and cooperation are essential. From my experience, being a class representative and helping classmates taught me that education isn't only about personal success — it's also about uplifting others.

5. Do you think helping others makes people happier? Why?

Yes, definitely. Psychologists even say that helping others releases positive chemicals in the brain, often called the "helper's high." Personally, whenever I've supported someone, like teaching my classmates or saving someone in a rescue operation, I felt a deep sense of inner peace and satisfaction. It's almost like you receive more joy than the person you helped.

6. Should governments encourage people to volunteer more?

Yes, governments should absolutely encourage volunteering. They can do this by recognizing volunteer hours, giving certificates, or even offering small incentives like scholarships for students who serve society. When citizens are motivated to volunteer, it strengthens the nation's resilience during crises like floods, earthquakes, or pandemics.

7. Do you think people sometimes help others for personal benefit rather than pure kindness?

That can happen. For instance, some people volunteer just to improve their résumé or gain social recognition. However, I don't necessarily see this as negative, because even if the motivation is mixed, the outcome is still positive. The person being helped still benefits, and sometimes people who start with selfish motives eventually develop genuine compassion.

8. What do you think is the future of helping others in our modern world?

I think the future of helping will become more global and technology-driven. With the rise of crowdfunding platforms, mobile apps, and international NGOs, people will be able to support strangers across the world within minutes. But at the same time, I believe the most meaningful help will always remain personal — being physically present for someone in need, offering emotional support, or risking your own safety, like in rescue operations.

Task = 24:

Describe a habit you have.

You should say:

what this habit is

how you developed this habit

whether it is a good or bad habit

and explain how you feel about having this habit.

I would like to talk about a very special habit of mine, which is *waking up early*. I usually wake up just before the Fajar prayer call, and I have maintained this habit for many years. I truly believe that the first hour of the day is the most productive. After offering my prayer, I usually work on my personal projects or sometimes do research for my Master's studies. This peaceful time, when the whole world is quiet, allows me to think clearly and focus better.

On weekdays, I dedicate this time to academics, but Sundays are a little different. Even though I wake up at the same time, I spend my early mornings helping the workers on our family's dairy farm. Being a Gujjar family, we have always been closely connected with dairy work and cultivation. I usually help in feeding the buffaloes, cutting grass, and even assisting in the milking process. These simple activities make me feel more grounded and connected to my family traditions.

My father doesn't allow me to do much farm work during weekdays, as he always advises me to concentrate on my studies. However, I feel that this Sunday routine balances my life. It not only reminds me of my cultural background but also gives me physical activity, which keeps me fit and energetic.

I personally think this habit is a blessing. Waking up early gives me a head start to the day, improves my concentration, and increases my productivity. At the same time, my Sunday mornings on the dairy farm remind me that no matter how far we go in education or career, we should always stay connected with our roots.

So, in short, waking up early is not just a habit for me — it's a lifestyle that brings discipline, productivity, and a sense of belonging to my life.

Part = 03

1. Do you think habits are important in life?

Absolutely, habits are like the backbone of our daily life. They shape our routine and, in the long run, our personality. For example, a person with the habit of waking up early naturally becomes more productive and disciplined. On the other hand, bad habits like procrastination or oversleeping can ruin opportunities. I feel habits are like seeds — if we plant the right ones, they grow into a fruitful tree of success.

2. How can people develop good habits?

I think the golden rule for developing good habits is consistency. No mountain is climbed in a single step — it's all about small daily actions. For instance, if someone wants to develop the habit of reading, they don't need to start with a whole book; even ten minutes a day can eventually make reading a natural part of life. Personally, I developed my habit of waking up early through prayer, and now it feels impossible for me to sleep late. Truly, old habits die hard, especially when they are good ones.

3. Why is it so difficult to break bad habits?

Breaking bad habits is tough because they usually give short-term comfort. For example, eating junk food feels satisfying at the moment but harms health in the long run. Our mind tricks us into enjoying the “easy way out.” I think the only way to fight this is by replacing the bad habit with a healthier one. Like, if someone tends to snack at midnight, they could replace chips with fruits. It's hard, no doubt, but as the saying goes, *no pain, no gain*.

4. Do you think children should be taught good habits at an early age?

Yes, one hundred percent. Childhood is like wet clay — it can be shaped easily. If kids are encouraged to wake up early, keep their surroundings clean, or respect elders from an early age, these habits become part of their personality forever. I've seen in my own family that the younger ones copy elders; for example, my little cousin started praying just because he saw me doing it every day. So I strongly believe that teaching habits at an early age is an investment in their character.

5. How do habits affect a person's success?

Habits are the secret ingredient behind every success story. A person with the habit of working hard and staying focused will naturally go far in life. Take athletes, for instance — their habit of regular training is what makes them champions. Even in academics, students who have the habit of daily study perform far better than those who rely on last-minute cramming. In my own case, the habit of waking up early has boosted my productivity, and I can say without exaggeration that *success is nothing but good habits repeated every day*.

6. Are traditional habits still important in modern life?

Definitely. Even though the world is moving fast with technology, traditional habits keep us connected to our roots. For example, in my family, the habit of dairy farming is not just about milk; it's about discipline, teamwork, and respecting nature. Such habits may look old-fashioned, but they teach us values that modern gadgets cannot replace. I think traditional habits are like anchors — they stop us from drifting away in the sea of modern life.

7. Do you think technology is changing people's habits?

Yes, without a doubt. Technology has completely reshaped our daily patterns. People now have the habit of scrolling through social media instead of reading books. Even meal times and sleeping patterns are affected because gadgets keep us awake late at night. While technology has given us convenience, it has also created unhealthy habits like addiction to screens. Personally, I try to balance it by using technology for learning and research but avoiding meaningless scrolling.

8. What's the difference between personal habits and social habits?

Personal habits are the ones we practice in our private life, like sleeping early, exercising, or studying daily. Social habits, on the other hand, are about how we behave with others — such as greeting people politely, respecting elders, or being punctual. Both are equally important. A person may have good personal habits, but if they lack good social habits, like being kind or respectful, society will not value them. I believe success in life requires harmony between the two.

Task 25:

A Painting You Like

Describe a painting that you like.

You should say:

what the painting is of

who painted it

when you first saw this painting

and explain why you like this painting.

I am very much into history, so the painting I want to talk about is one that is extremely close to my heart. It is a painting of **Sultan Abdul Hamid II**, the last great

Sultan of the Ottoman Empire. In the painting, he is holding the flag of the Khilafat, standing tall and resisting against the oppressive system of colonial powers. The background is very dramatic: fire is painted in three different colors. The **white flames** symbolize betrayal from his own nation, the **red flames** resemble the Russian flag, and the **blue flames** represent the British government.

I bought this painting in Turkey from a local lady painter named Aslahan. She signed her name on the corner, and I still remember how passionately she explained the meaning behind it. From that moment, I felt a deep connection, not just with the painting but with the history and struggles it represents.

This painting hangs in my bedroom, so I see it almost every day. Every time I look at it, I feel inspired and I silently make *duwa* for him. Sultan Abdul Hamid was not only a ruler but also a man of justice who provided shelter to Muslims, Christians, and Jews without any discrimination. That kind of leadership is rare, and it touches me deeply.

I respect him so much that sometimes I even wish I could meet him in my dreams, or perhaps in the hereafter, just to witness his greatness and his service to humanity. For me, this painting is not just a piece of art; it is a **reminder of courage, sacrifice, and justice**.

In short, I love this painting because it connects me to my history, keeps me motivated to stand for justice, and reminds me that true leadership means serving all people equally. As the saying goes, *a picture is worth a thousand words*, and this one speaks directly to my heart.

Part 03:

1. Do you think paintings are still important in today's modern world?

Answer:

Yes, definitely. Even though we live in a digital age, paintings are still very important because they preserve emotions and history in a way that technology cannot. For example, when I look at the painting of Sultan Abdul Hamid II, I don't just see colors on a canvas—I feel the struggle, the pain, and the courage of that era. Paintings have the power to make us stop, reflect, and connect with our past.

In fact, in today's fast-paced world, I think they are even more important because they remind us of values like patience, sacrifice, and humanity.

2. Do you prefer modern art or traditional art? Why?

Answer:

Personally, I prefer traditional art because it tells stories of real people, cultures, and struggles. Traditional paintings often carry history and emotions, like the Ottoman painting I mentioned. Modern art is creative, but sometimes it feels abstract and disconnected from reality. Traditional art, on the other hand, gives me wisdom and motivation, because it links me to the lives and sacrifices of our ancestors. However, I also respect modern art because it allows freedom of expression.

3. Can paintings influence people?

Answer:

Absolutely, paintings can influence people more than words sometimes. For example, my painting of Sultan Abdul Hamid II constantly inspires me to stand for justice and to value unity. Paintings can change our mood, inspire revolutions, and even educate people who may not read books. They are visual reminders of ideas and emotions. In fact, many freedom movements used posters and paintings to awaken courage in the public.

4. How can schools and universities promote art among students?

Answer:

I think schools and universities should organize regular art exhibitions where students can display their work, not just for beauty but also for meaningful messages. Art should not be treated as a side subject—it should be connected with history, culture, and social studies. For example, a painting about Palestine or Kashmir could teach students more about justice and humanity than a simple textbook line. Giving students platforms, workshops, and appreciation will motivate them to see art as a voice, not just decoration.

5. Do you think every painting has a message?

Answer:

Not every painting, but the most powerful ones surely do. Some paintings are only decorative, but great paintings always carry deeper meanings. The painting I like of Sultan Abdul Hamid II is full of symbolism—the white, red, and blue flames represent betrayal and foreign oppression. That hidden meaning makes the painting unforgettable. In my opinion, the best art is the one that makes you think, feel, and reflect.

Task 26:

Part 1: Travel

Describe an unusual classroom lesson you had.

You should say:

when this lesson was

where this lesson was

who was in this classroom lesson

and explain why this classroom lesson was so unusual.

Well, one unusual classroom lesson that I still remember very vividly happened last year in my college. It was supposed to be our regular history class, but instead of staying inside the classroom, our teacher invited a guest speaker — a well-known historian from a local university.

To make the experience memorable, he asked us to leave the classroom and sit under the big banyan tree in our college courtyard. At first, it felt more like a picnic than a formal lesson, because we were sitting on the grass in fresh air, rather than on uncomfortable chairs in a stuffy room.

The guest speaker didn't open a textbook or use PowerPoint slides. Instead, he started narrating historical events like fascinating stories. He told us about great leaders, their struggles, and even the emotional side of history that we usually ignore. The way he described battles, culture, and leadership made us feel as if we were actually there. Sometimes he even changed his voice to act like different historical characters, which made the whole lesson very engaging.

This experience was unusual because it broke the traditional idea of teaching. Normally, history lessons feel heavy, full of dates and facts to memorize. But that day, it became a living story. I was so inspired that I started reading more about history in my free time, something I had never done before.

Honestly, I felt motivated and lucky to be part of that lesson. It taught me that education doesn't have to be boring or limited to four walls; if taught creatively, even the most difficult subject can become a source of inspiration.

Part 03:

1. Do you think students learn better inside classrooms or outside classrooms?

I strongly believe students learn better when education goes beyond the four walls of a classroom. Of course, classrooms provide structure and discipline, but outdoor learning sparks creativity and curiosity. For example, when we had that history lesson under the tree, I felt much more engaged and less restricted. It was like breaking the monotony. As the saying goes, *"A change of scene can change the state of mind."* So, blending both methods is the best way forward.

2. How important is creativity in teaching?

In my view, creativity is the lifeblood of teaching. If a teacher only reads from a book, students quickly lose interest. But when lessons are made interactive — through storytelling, role-play, or even field trips — they stick in the students' memory. I still remember one of my science teachers who used daily life examples like cooking or sports to explain complicated concepts. That kind of creativity not only makes learning enjoyable but also long-lasting.

3. Why do some students find lessons boring?

Honestly, I think lessons feel boring when they are too one-sided. If a teacher only lectures and students are passive listeners, it becomes dull. Another reason is the lack of practical application — if students don't see how knowledge connects to real life, they lose interest. I've noticed that whenever teachers link theories to personal stories or current events, suddenly the class becomes alive. So, boredom usually comes from lack of connection, not from the subject itself.

4. How can teachers make lessons more interesting?

Teachers can make lessons engaging by adding variety. For instance, using multimedia, group discussions, or even outdoor activities. I once had a teacher who started every lecture with a thought-provoking question instead of jumping into the topic. That instantly caught our attention. In short, if teachers mix information with imagination, students will not only learn better but also enjoy the process.

5. Do you think technology has changed the way lessons are delivered?

Absolutely, technology has revolutionized education. Today, we don't rely solely on chalkboards and textbooks. Smart boards, online resources, and even virtual reality are being used in classrooms. For example, students can take virtual tours of historical sites while sitting in their school. That's something previous generations could never dream of. However, I still believe technology should support teachers, not replace them, because the human connection in teaching is irreplaceable.

6. Are unusual lessons more memorable than regular ones? Why?

Definitely yes. Unusual lessons break the routine and touch emotions, which makes them stick in our minds. For instance, the outdoor history class I mentioned is still fresh in my memory, while I have forgotten countless regular classes. This happens because the brain remembers experiences that are different from the norm — they stand out like colorful pages in a black-and-white book.

7. Should schools organize more guest lectures or special sessions?

Yes, I think schools should do it more often. Guest speakers bring fresh perspectives and real-world experiences that regular teachers sometimes cannot provide. When an expert shares personal struggles and success stories, students feel inspired. I still remember a guest speaker who visited our college and spoke about entrepreneurship; that session motivated many of my classmates to start their own projects. It shows how powerful such interactions can be.

8. Do you think unusual lessons can influence a student's career choices?

Without a doubt. Sometimes a single unusual lesson or inspiring lecture can plant a seed in a student's mind that grows into a lifelong passion. For example, I have a friend who attended a biology field trip in school, and that sparked her interest in

becoming a doctor. Similarly, unusual lessons often open new doors and help students see possibilities beyond the curriculum.